

ĐẠI HỌC KINH TẾ THÀNH PHỐ HỒ CHÍ MINH

TRƯỜNG KINH DOANH



**ĐỀ TÀI GIẢI THƯỞNG NGHIÊN CỨU KHOA HỌC SINH VIÊN CẤP
TRƯỜNG KINH DOANH**

COBRP 2025

**Tên đề tài: THE IMPACT OF MINIMALIST LIFESTYLE ON SUSTAINABLE
FASHION CONSUMPTION INTENTIONS**

Tác giả: Trương Ý Như
Phan Thị Như Hiền
Trương Nguyễn Uyên Nhi
Nguyễn Thu Thủy
Lê Thị Bảo Trâm

TP. Hồ Chí Minh - Tháng 10/2025

ABSTRACT

Amid environmental degradation and unsustainable consumption, greenwashing and sustainable label awareness have become major barriers to green fashion consumption in Ho Chi Minh City. This study, titled “The Impact of Factors Influencing Minimalist Lifestyle and Sustainable Fashion Consumption Intention”, investigates how simple aesthetics, greenwashing perception, price perception, sustainable label awareness, and environmental concern influence consumers’ sustainable fashion consumption intention in Ho Chi Minh City, with minimalism as a mediating factor. The research framework integrates the Theory of Planned Behavior (TPB) and the Stimulus-Organism-Response (SOR) theory, Perceived Value Theory (PVT) and Psychological Reactance Theory (PRT).

Data were collected from 354 valid surveys via Google Forms, targeting consumers familiar with the minimalist lifestyle in Ho Chi Minh City, and analyzed using SmartPLS 4.0 to assess reliability, validity, and relationships between variables. Findings reveal that minimalist aesthetics, greenwashing perception, and price perception positively influence minimalism, whereas sustainable label awareness and environmental concern show no significant impact. Minimalism and price perception positively affect sustainable fashion consumption intention, while environmental concern does not. Minimalism mediates the relationship between minimalist aesthetics and sustainable fashion consumption intention.

The study provides deep insights into the psychological mechanisms of sustainable fashion consumption, emphasizing the roles of minimalism and price perception. Fashion businesses should enhance transparency in sustainable labeling and develop simple, eco-friendly products to promote green consumption. Limitations include the survey sample’s focus on Ho Chi Minh City, necessitating broader studies for greater generalizability. The findings offer theoretical and practical implications, supporting the promotion of sustainable consumption in Vietnam.

Keywords: minimalism, sustainable fashion consumption intention, greenwashing perception, price perception, simple aesthetics.

TABLE OF CONTENTS

ABSTRACT	1
LIST OF TABLE	5
LIST OF FIGURES	6
CHAPTER 1: INTRODUCTION	7
1.1. Research background	7
1.2. Research Objectives	10
<i>1.2.1. Overall Objective</i>	<i>10</i>
<i>1.2.2. Specific Objectives</i>	<i>10</i>
1.3. Research Questions	11
1.4. Subject and scope of research	11
1.5. Research Methodology	11
1.6. Thesis Structure	12
CHAPTER 2: THEORETICAL FRAMEWORK	14
2.1. Fundamental theories	14
<i>2.1.1. Theory of Planned Behavior (TPB)</i>	<i>14</i>
<i>2.1.2. Stimulus-Organism-Response (SOR) Theory</i>	<i>15</i>
<i>2.1.3. Perceived Value Theory (PVT)</i>	<i>17</i>
<i>2.1.4. Psychological Reactance Theory (PRT)</i>	<i>18</i>
2.2. Definition of Concepts	19
<i>2.2.1. Minimalism</i>	<i>19</i>
<i>2.2.2. Sustainable Fashion Consumption Intention</i>	<i>19</i>
<i>2.2.3. Greenwashing Perception</i>	<i>20</i>
<i>2.2.4. Sustainable Label Awareness</i>	<i>20</i>

2.3. Literature Review	22
2.4. Proposed Hypotheses and Research Model	33
<i>2.4.1. The relationship between Simple Aesthetics and Minimalism</i>	<i>33</i>
<i>2.4.2. The relationship between Greenwashing Perception and Minimalism</i>	<i>34</i>
<i>2.4.3. The relationship between Sustainable Label Awareness and Minimalism</i>	<i>35</i>
<i>2.4.4. The relationship between Environmental Concern and Minimalism</i>	<i>35</i>
<i>2.4.5. The relationship between Price Perception and Minimalism</i>	<i>36</i>
<i>2.4.6. The relationship between Environmental Concern and Sustainable Fashion Consumption Intention</i>	<i>37</i>
<i>2.4.7. The relationship between Price Perception and Sustainable Fashion Consumption Intention</i>	<i>38</i>
<i>2.4.8. The relationship between Minimalism and the Sustainable Fashion Consumption Intention.</i>	<i>39</i>
2.5. Proposed Research Model	41
CHAPTER 3: RESEARCH METHODOLOGY	42
3.1. Introduction	42
3.2. Research Design	42
<i>3.2.1. Research Methodology</i>	<i>42</i>
<i>3.2.2. Research Process</i>	<i>44</i>
3.3. Measurement Scales	44
<i>3.3.1. Measurement Scale for Simple Aesthetic</i>	<i>44</i>
<i>3.3.2. Measurement Scale for Greenwashing Perception</i>	<i>45</i>
<i>3.3.3. Measurement Scale for Sustainable Label Awareness</i>	<i>45</i>
<i>3.3.4. Measurement Scale for Environmental Concern</i>	<i>46</i>

3.3.5. <i>Measurement Scale for Price Perception</i>	46
3.3.6. <i>Measurement Scale for Minimalism</i>	46
3.3.7. <i>Measurement Scale for Sustainable Fashion Consumption Intention</i>	47
3.4. Sample size	47
3.5. Summary	48
CHAPTER 4: RESEARCH RESULTS	48
4.1. Descriptive statistics	48
4.2. Measurement Model Evaluation	51
4.2.1. <i>Scale Reliability</i>	51
4.2.2. <i>Assessment of Convergent Validity</i>	53
4.2.3. <i>Discriminant Validity-Heterotrait-Monotrait Ratio (HTMT)</i>	53
4.3. Structural Model Evaluation	54
4.3.1. <i>Multicollinearity Assessment (VIF)</i>	54
4.3.2. <i>Coefficient of Determination (R^2 and Adjusted R^2)</i>	55
4.3.3. <i>Effect Size (f^2)</i>	56
4.3.4. <i>Bootstrapping Test and Assessment of Path Relationship Significance</i>	57
4.4. Mediation Analysis	61
4.5. Discussion of Research Results	63
CHAPTER 5: CONCLUSION AND IMPLICATIONS	69
5.1. Conclusion	69
5.2. Research implications	70
5.2.1. <i>Theoretical implications</i>	70
5.2.2. <i>Practical implications</i>	71
5.3. Limitations and Future Research	73

REFERENCES**74****APPENDIX****84**

LIST OF TABLE

<i>Table 2.3. Related Studies</i>	22
<i>Table 4.1. Descriptive Statistics of Survey Participants</i>	49
<i>Table 4.2.1. Results of Cronbach's Alpha, Composite Reliability, Outer Loadings, and Average Variance Extracted (AVE)</i>	51
<i>Table 4.2.3. Heterotrait-Monotrait Ratio (HTMT) of the Scales</i>	54
<i>Table 4.3.1. Multicollinearity Statistics: Variance Inflation Factor (VIF) Results</i>	55
<i>Table 4.3.2. R² Test Results</i>	56
<i>Table 4.3.3. Effect Size (f²) Results</i>	56
<i>Table 4.3.4. Results of Research Hypothesis Testing in the Model</i>	60
<i>Table 4.3.5. Summary of Hypothesis Testing Results</i>	61
<i>Table 4.4. Results of hypothesis testing in the model</i>	62

LIST OF FIGURES

<i>Figure 1. Theory of Planned Behavior TPB</i>	15
<i>Figure 2. Proposed Research Model</i>	41
<i>Figure 3. Research Process Design</i>	44
<i>Figure 4. Results of Bootstrapping Test</i>	58
<i>Figure 5. Results of the Research Model Analysis</i>	68

CHAPTER 1: INTRODUCTION

1.1. Research background

Over the past several decades, environmental degradation and unsustainable consumption have become among the most critical global challenges. While numerous initiatives have focused on advancing cleaner production technologies, such efforts remain insufficient to comprehensively mitigate the adverse impacts originating from consumers' choices, behavioral patterns, and disposal practices. The widespread dominance of materialistic values and mass-consumption culture has exacerbated environmental consequences, including pollution, depletion of natural resources, and climate change (Kang, Martinez, & Johnson, 2021). The generation of municipal solid waste is expected to increase from 2.1 billion tonnes in 2023 to 3.8 billion tonnes by 2050. In Vietnam, according to the Ministry of Natural Resources and Environment's 2025 Report, Vietnam generates over 23 million tons of household waste annually, along with over 7 million tons of industrial solid waste and over 630,000 tons of hazardous waste. Therefore, the study of factors driving "sustainable consumption" has attracted significant interest from many researchers worldwide (UNEP, 2024).

Specifically, the fashion, clothing, and textile industries have been widely identified as major contributors to environmental degradation (Rume & Islam, 2020), making them responsible for ecological and social issues such as climate change, natural resource scarcity, and chemical abuse (Ertekin & Atik, 2020). There are many research findings that point to the environmental impacts of this fast fashion industry, such as water pollution (Abbas, Chiang Hsieh, Techato, & Taweeekun, 2020); greenhouse gas emissions from fossil fuel processing and the use of toxic chemicals (Khurana & Ricchetti, 2016). Therefore, there are growing concerns about the social impacts of the fast fashion industry, as fast fashion market revenue reached a high of \$30.58 billion in 2023, while revenue from the sustainable fashion market was only \$8.25 billion. (Trueman & Management, 2022). According to Eco - Stylist's (2022) research, in the world of fast fashion consumers, people buy over 60% more clothes than they did 20 years ago, and

the consumption time is less than a year, meaning over 50% of clothes end up in landfills. Similarly in Vietnam, according to ECBD 2023, the fast fashion market shows strong growth figures, with a capacity of approximately 4 billion USD in 2023 and is projected to reach 6.5 billion USD by 2028, with an annual compound growth rate (CAGR) of about 10% from 2024-2028. This development is driven by rising incomes, a growing middle class, and changing consumer trends. Consumer demand is the main reason for the rapid growth of the fast fashion market. Therefore, this unsustainable consumption poses the greatest challenge for governments in promoting a green economy and achieving one of the sustainable development goals, which is sustainable consumption practices.

Sustainable consumption has emerged as an urgent requirement to address environmental issues, advocating for consumption models that minimize ecological impact while meeting current and future needs (United Nations, 2024). Sustainable consumption has become one of the most important aspects, with increasing interest from many consumers.

Sustainable consumption has emerged as an urgent imperative for addressing environmental challenges, promoting models of consumption that minimize ecological impact while fulfilling both present and future needs (United Nations, 2024). It has become one of the most critical dimensions of modern consumer behavior, attracting growing attention from individuals and institutions alike. Recent global statistics further illustrate this shift. Based on a survey conducted in 2023 by IBM and the National Retail Federation, almost 70% of global consumers reported that they are willing to pay a premium for products that are environmentally responsible or ethically produced. In recent years, the demand for sustainable consumption in Vietnam has seen a significant increase. Consumers are increasingly choosing to use green, environmentally friendly consumer products. As reported by the Ministry of Industry and Trade, the demand for green products in Vietnam increased by an average of 15% annually from 2021 to 2023. More than 72% of Vietnamese consumers express a willingness to spend extra on green products, reflecting a rising awareness and concern for environmental issues. Sustainable consumption is not just a trend, but also a key factor in helping businesses achieve

sustainable development and enhance their competitiveness. (Haller, Wallace, Cheung, & Gupta, 2022).

In recent years, global consumerism has witnessed strong growth due to internationalization, rising living standards, and exposure to diverse cultures, leading to a more experience-based economy (Pangarkar, Shukla, & Taylor, 2021). A unique aspect of this experience economy involves a novel social movement called minimalism. Minimalism is being promoted as a new form of consumption compatible with environmental sustainability, economic practices, technological progress, and psychological well-being. This ideology has universal appeal for both social and individual needs, making it a compelling alternative to traditional consumer behavior. Increased awareness of environmental concerns like climate change and resource scarcity has prompted many individuals to reconsider their purchasing behaviors. Embracing minimalism aligns with a sustainable and eco-friendly way of living (Vollebregt, Mugge, Thürridl, & van Dolen, 2023). Minimalism, a consumer trend, has gained popularity, representing a deliberate lifestyle philosophy characterized by actively reducing possessions and prioritizing simplicity (Wilson, & Bellezza, 2024). Minimalism emphasized owning less, reducing excessive consumption, and enhancing one's quality of life by curbing spending (Pangarkar, Shukla, & Taylor, 2021). For this reason, there is a global trend toward pursuing a strong lifestyle. According to a YouGov survey of 8,148 Americans, 26% of Americans identify as living a minimalist lifestyle (YouGov, 2025). In Vietnam, according to a survey by Tuoi Tre newspaper (2023), 47% of young Vietnamese people (aged 18-35) expressed interest in sustainable lifestyles, with minimalism playing a significant role. They see this not only as a way to reduce financial pressure but also as a means to protect the environment and improve their quality of life. The rise of this trend in Vietnam is a notable social phenomenon, reflecting a shift in the value system of a new generation.

However, as of now, these studies still have certain gaps. One of the biggest debates is the "awareness-action gap" Many studies show that despite consumers becoming increasingly aware of environmental issues, the actual rate of sustainable consumption

practices remains very low. In Vietnam, a survey by the Association of High-Quality Vietnamese Enterprises (2024) shows that only about 12-18% of consumers in major cities truly pursue this lifestyle. The conflict between "knowing" and "doing" is a major question whose answer is still widely debated. Therefore, the authors continued to explore ways of life or factors that could transform awareness into concrete action, and "minimalism" emerged as a promising new approach.

Thus, minimalism is a phenomenon that is thriving and rapidly developing in the market and in society. Researching the nature of minimalism, its components, the factors that influence it (simple aesthetics, greenwashing perception, perception of sustainable labels, price perception, and environmental concern), and how it can serve as a bridge to promote sustainable consumption is necessary. The research results are not only scientifically significant but also have important implications for corporate management practices and policy planning, aiming to develop effective strategies to encourage a more sustainable living and consuming community.

1.2. Research Objectives

1.2.1. Overall Objective

Sustainable consumption trends and minimalist lifestyles are gaining increasing attention in the fashion industry. However, the role of minimalism in promoting sustainable fashion consumption intentions still needs to be explored. The study not only sheds light on the mechanism by which minimalism influences and shifts from material consumption to prioritizing sustainable values, but also promotes the intention to choose environmentally friendly fashion. Through this, the study not only contributes to clarifying the role of minimalism as a driver of sustainable consumption but also provides practical insights to help businesses and policymakers develop more suitable strategies such as developing circular supply chains, designing recycled products, or enhancing corporate social responsibility communication, with the aim of forming a more responsible and sustainable fashion ecosystem.

1.2.2. Specific Objectives

The role of minimalism is increasingly significant in people's current fashion consumption intentions, especially in connection with the trend of sustainable consumption. Based on this foundation, the present study was carried out with the aim of achieving specific research objectives. Determine the factors influencing Minimalism and Sustainable Fashion Consumption Intention Assessment of the impact of each factor on Minimalism, as well as the direct impact of certain factors on sustainable fashion consumption intentions. Clarifying the mediating role of Minimalism in the relationship between factors and sustainable fashion consumption intentions. Suggest management implications to help businesses orient their strategies to raise awareness of minimalism and promote sustainable fashion consumption intentions in Ho Chi Minh City.

1.3. Research Questions

Based on the issues identified above, the research team proposes the following research questions:

1. What factors impact Minimalism and the Intention for Sustainable Fashion Consumption?
2. How is the level of influence of each of the above factors on Minimalism and the Intention for Sustainable Fashion Consumption demonstrated?
3. How does Minimalism act as a mediator in the relationship between the influencing factors and the Intention for Sustainable Fashion Consumption?
4. What solutions are needed to enhance awareness of minimalism and promote the intention for sustainable fashion consumption in Ho Chi Minh City?

1.4. Subject and scope of research

Research Object: To study the impact of factors affecting minimalism on the intention for sustainable fashion consumption.

Survey Subjects: The survey subjects are consumers of all ages in Ho Chi Minh City who are aware of or have heard about the minimalist lifestyle.

Scope of Research:

Spatial Scope: The research is conducted in Ho Chi Minh City.

Temporal Scope: The survey and data collection will be carried out from September 25, 2025, to October 9, 2025.

1.5. Research Methodology

The study primarily uses two main methods: qualitative and quantitative research.

Qualitative Research Method: This is conducted by collecting opinions and viewpoints from consumers in Ho Chi Minh City to supplement and adjust the observational variables, thereby refining the measurement scales and survey questionnaire for the main research phase.

Quantitative Research Method: This is the primary method, conducted through an online survey using a detailed questionnaire. The quantitative research will be carried out via online surveys using Google Forms, targeting consumers in Ho Chi Minh City through random probability sampling. A 5-point Likert scale will be used to measure variables such as attitudes toward minimalism, sustainable consumption behavior, and the influence of this lifestyle on sustainable consumption intentions. The collected data will be processed using SmartPLS 4.0 software. Analytical techniques will test reliability using a Structural Equation Model (SEM). Hypothesis testing will be performed using the Bootstrapping method, with evaluation metrics such as p-value, R^2 , and f^2 . Through these analytical results, the study will draw scientific conclusions about the relationships within the model.

1.6. Thesis Structure

Chapter 1: Introduction. This chapter presents the rationale, general objectives, specific objectives, research subjects, research scope, research methodology, significance, and the overall structure of the research.

Chapter 2: Theoretical Framework. This chapter presents the theoretical foundation, including key concepts, foundational theories, and a review of domestic and international studies. Based on this, it proposes the research model and hypotheses.

Chapter 3: Research Methodology. This chapter outlines the research process, scale design, questionnaire design, scale development, survey sample collection, and provides a detailed description of each quantitative research method used.

Chapter 4: Research Results. This chapter covers data processing, analysis of the results based on the chosen research methods, and presents the findings.

Chapter 5: Conclusion And Implications. This chapter provides conclusions, discusses managerial implications, identifies the limitations of the study, and finally, suggests directions for future research.

CHAPTER 2: THEORETICAL FRAMEWORK

2.1. Fundamental theories

2.1.1. Theory of Planned Behavior (TPB)

The Theory of Planned Behavior (TPB) was introduced by Ajzen (1991) as an expansion of the Theory of Reasoned Action (TRA). The major difference between TPB and TRA is the variable addition of “perceived behavioral control” to simplify behaviors that are not completely under the control of the individual. The introduction of TPB marked a significant step forward in the study of human behavior, as it broadened the scope of explanation and prediction to more complex domains, ranging from health and education to the environment and consumption (Ajzen, 1991).

The core of TPB is the idea of behavioral intention. It is considered the most immediate and powerful predictor of current actions. Behavioral intention indicates a person's desire to engage in a particular behavior; the stronger the intention, the higher the likelihood that the behavior will occur. Ajzen (1991) suggests that the intention to behave is shaped by three key determinants: attitude toward the behavior, which reflects a person's positive or negative evaluation of the behavior; subjective norms, which gather observed expectations to participate or refrain from participating in the behavior; and perceived behavioral control, which represents a person's confidence in their ability to execute and control the behavior.

Ajzen emphasizes the impact of subjective norms on behavioral intention, noting that they reflect the “perceived social pressure to perform or not to perform the behavior”. Finally, perceived behavioral control represents a person's perception of their capability to engage in a specific behavior. It encompasses both their self-confidence in performing the behavior and their perception of potential barriers or facilitating factors that may influence its execution. Ajzen highlights that perceived behavioral control shapes behavioral intention and indirectly influences behavior (Ajzen, 2002). He argues that individuals tend to form intentions and engage in behaviors when they feel certain about their ability to

control the situation. Ajzen further stresses the distinction between perceived behavioral control and actual behavioral control, asserting that both aspects influence behavioral prediction (Ajzen, 2002). While perceived control affects intention, actual control can directly influence behavior, underscoring the need to consider both aspects when evaluating behavioral outcomes.

In the study of minimalism, TPB can be applied to explain how psychosocial factors influence the intention and practice of this lifestyle. An individual will have a stronger intention to live a minimalist life when they hold a positive attitude toward reducing possessions and engaging in selective consumption, when they perceive social support through subjective norms, and when they think they possess sufficient capability to control their shopping habits and product choices. Thus, TPB not only helps to explain the formation of intention and sustainable consumption behavior but also highlights the mediating role of minimalism in connecting personal and social factors with responsible consumption outcomes.

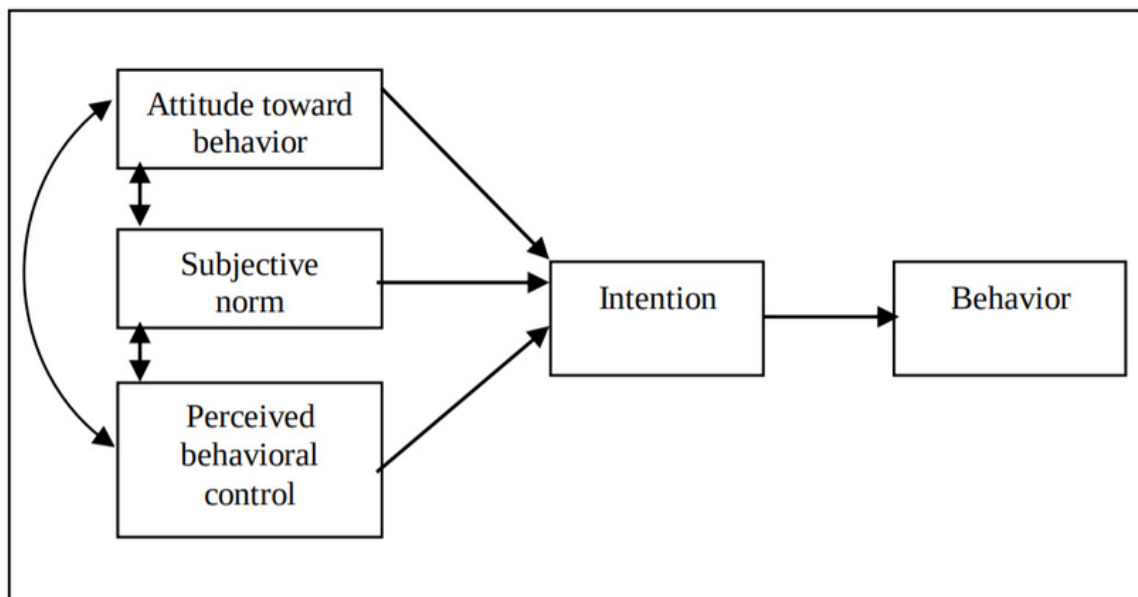


Figure 1. Theory of Planned Behavior TPB

2.1.2. Stimulus-Organism-Response (SOR) Theory

This study applies the Stimulus-Organism-Response (SOR) theory, which originates from environmental psychology, to analyze sustainable fashion consumption intention, where Minimalism plays a crucial role in Ho Chi Minh City. SOR theory explores complex relationships, establishing a clear logical chain to achieve the research objectives: identifying factors that affect Minimalism and Sustainable Fashion Consumption Intention, assessing the impact level of each factor, clarifying the mediating role of Minimalism, and proposing managerial implications for businesses. With its flexibility unconstrained by a fixed structure, SOR allows for adaptation to research variables (Yadav & Kar, 2024), linking values, perceptions, and emotions to consumer behavior.

Mehrabian and Russell's (1974) SOR theoretical framework states that environmental stimuli (Stimulus - S) affect the internal state of an individual, known as the organism (Organism - O), leading to a behavioral response (Response - R). In this study, the stimuli are identified as external environmental cues that influence fashion consumption behavior, including: Simple Aesthetics, Greenwashing Perception, Price Perception, and Sustainable Label Awareness. These factors represent signals from products and the market, playing an important role in shaping the awareness and attitudes of consumers in Ho Chi Minh City, where the trend of sustainable consumption is growing strongly.

The organism state is considered a psychological transformation mechanism where stimuli are converted into cognitive and emotional responses. In this study, Minimalism is chosen as the main mediating variable in the organism state, reflecting an attitude or lifestyle formed by stimuli such as Simple Aesthetics, Greenwashing Perception, and Sustainable Label Awareness. Additionally, Environmental Concern is regarded as a supporting element in the internal state, reinforcing the awareness of sustainable values and environmental responsibility, through that contributing to shaping the consumer attitudes of the urban population. The mediating role of Minimalism is emphasized as a crucial bridge, transforming environmental impacts into sustainable behavioral intentions.

The response in the model is the Intention to Consume Sustainable Fashion, representing a consumer's conscious commitment to environmentally friendly fashion

consumption behaviors. This intention is not only directly influenced by certain stimuli (such as Sustainable Label Awareness and Environmental Concern) but is also shaped through the mediating role of Minimalism. This finding provides a basis for the proposed managerial implications, which are based on enhancing awareness of Minimalism and related factors, thereby helping businesses build strategies to promote sustainable consumption in Ho Chi Minh City.

The SOR theory has proven effective in green consumer behavior research, with diverse applications across num, such as social networking services, where information avoidance is seen as a response (Kumalasari & Priharsari, 2023), as well as fashion related social e-commerce, where ongoing purchase intention is examined as a reaction (Hewei & Youngsook, 2022). The study by Yadav and Kar (2024) also successfully applied SOR to analyze the impact of religious values and Minimalism on the intention to repurchase sustainable fashion, thereby affirming the applicability of SOR in the context of this study, especially when integrated with TPB to clarify detailed behavioral mechanisms.

2.1.3. Perceived Value Theory (PVT)

Zeithaml (1988) introduced Perceived Value Theory (PVT) to explain how consumers evaluate and make purchasing decisions predicated on a comparison between perceived benefits and perceived sacrifices. Accordingly, “perceived value” is understood as the consumer's overall evaluation of a good or service, based on their perception of what they receive versus what they must give up. Unlike objective value, perceived value is subjective, formed from individual perceptions, expectations, and experiences (Zeithaml, 1988).

Subsequent research has expanded this concept in a multidimensional direction. The PERVAL scale was developed by Sweeney and Soutar (2001), identifying four main components of perceived value: (1) functional value - related to product quality and performance; (2) emotional value - the positive feelings experienced; (3) social value - the social image or status associated with the product; and (4) conditional value that depends on a specific consumption context. This model helps to understand more deeply how

consumers evaluate the overall product experience, not just based on price or functionality (Sweeney & Soutar, 2001).

In the context of modern consumption, especially sustainable consumption and minimalist lifestyles, PVT becomes a useful theoretical framework for analyzing how consumers redefine value beyond material benefits. The perception of price not only reflects affordability but also an assessment of fairness, reasonableness, and the meaning of consumption. For those pursuing minimalism, perceived value is formed based on simplicity, utility, and spiritual value rather than quantity or ostentatious value. Therefore, PVT provides an important foundation for explaining the relationship between price perception and the tendency toward minimalism, through the mechanism of balancing perceived benefits and perceived sacrifices in consumer behavior.

2.1.4. Psychological Reactance Theory (PRT)

Jack W. Brehm (1966) proposed Psychological Reactance Theory (PRT), posits that when people feel that their freedom of choice is being challenged or limited, they experience a state of motivation of psychological reaction to regain that independence. This state can manifest as feelings of discomfort, refusal to comply, or engaging in behavior contrary to the external message or pressure (Brehm, 1966).

Recent studies show that psychological reactance can affect behavioral intentions and the decision-making process of consumers. When the perception of being controlled increases, consumers tend to reduce their trust in marketing messages, thereby weakening the effectiveness of communication strategies. Conversely, when messages emphasize choice and autonomy, reactance decreases, leading to higher acceptance.

In the context of consumer behavior, psychological reactance often occurs when consumers feel coerced, manipulated, or lacking sufficient decision-making power. For example, high-pressure marketing strategies such as scarcity messages ("today only"), binding advertisements, or limited choices can trigger psychological reactance, leading consumers to refuse to buy or seek alternatives to assert their freedom (Brehm & Brehm, 1981). One increasingly common factor causing psychological reactance in consumer

behavior is greenwashing, the phenomenon where businesses make false or exaggerated sustainability claims to create a "green" image to attract customers. When consumers perceive this deception, they feel their freedom of choice is being manipulated. A significant consequence of this reactance state is a shift towards more independent and autonomous consumption models. Consumers tend to reduce trend-based consumption, limit their reliance on marketing messages, and focus on making fewer but more meaningful choices to avoid being led by greenwashing strategies. In other words, a high awareness of greenwashing can trigger psychological reactance, thereby increasing the tendency toward minimalist consumption as a way to restore behavioral control and protect one's autonomy.

2.2. Definition of Concepts

2.2.1. Minimalism

According to the philosophy of “less is more”, the 1960s saw the rise of minimalism as a visual art movement., reflecting both a cultural movement away from excess and toward simplicity. This concept gradually gained popularity in the consumer domain, especially as the negative impacts of materialism on personal well-being, society, and the environment became increasingly apparent (Wilson & Bellezza, 2021). Minimalism refers to the elimination of excess from one's life by concentrating on what is most important, cutting back on unnecessary spending, and enhancing life quality by abstaining from materialism (Shafqat, Ishaq, & Ahmed, 2023). According to Kang, Martinez, and Johnson (2021), the origins of minimalism can be traced to mass consumer societies, and it has recently attracted significant interest from researchers globally as it provides a basis for examining anti-consumption motives and encourages the careful consideration of a few material possessions as a source of a fulfilling and satisfying life.

Based on Naman Sreen, Mehrotra, Rsha Alghafes, and Agarwal (2024) studied minimalism as a system of values that affects ethical consumption behavior. Minimalists often live uncluttered lives, keeping only a few truly essential items and always thinking carefully before purchasing anything new (Kang, Martinez, & Johnson, 2021). In this paper,

we define minimalism as a lifestyle focused on reducing material possessions and unnecessary consumption, retaining only what is truly valuable.

2.2.2. Sustainable Fashion Consumption Intention

Based on extensive academic discussions on the topic, the notion of sustainable consumption has been shaped by major international conferences. The definition from the Oslo Symposium on Sustainable Consumption (1998) states that in order to protect the needs of future generations, it is utilizing services and associated goods to meet basic necessities and enhance quality of life and improve quality of life while reducing the use of toxic materials and natural resources in addition to waste and pollution emissions throughout the life cycle of the service or product. Similarly, the Rio Earth Summit (1992) highlighted the need for a new definition of prosperity, with the goal of raising living standards by reducing reliance on the planet's limited resources and promoting sustainable lifestyles. In this study, the research team adopts the definition from the Oslo Symposium (1998) as the central theoretical foundation.

2.2.3. Greenwashing Perception

Greenwashing is the act of companies intentionally deceiving or defrauding customers with false claims about their environmental actions and impacts to build a public reputation or shape a positive image among consumers (Zhang, Li, Cao, & Huang, 2018). According to Adamkiewicz, Kochanska, Adamkiewicz, and Łukasik (2022), greenwashing is based on highlighting a single positive activity or a small part of their operations while concealing all other activities that have a negative environmental impact, with the aim of presenting themselves as more sustainable than they actually are. In the fashion industry, greenwashing is observed through sustainability claims where environmental improvements are, in fact, limited to a very small portion of collections. Furthermore, heavily promoting take-back programs is another tactic, as these programs often encourage consumers to shop without guilt rather than addressing the core problem of overproduction.

According to Font, Andreu, Mattila, and Aldas-Manzano (2025), customers' opinions of greenwashing vary over time depending on their expectations and level of understanding, and there is a thin line between what is and is not greenwashing. The perception of greenwashing refers to consumers' awareness that businesses promote environmental-related communications without corresponding practical actions; when this perception is clear, consumers will not purchase from that company (Nyilasy, Gangadharbatla, & Paladino, 2014). In this study, we define Greenwashing Perception in the context of the fashion industry as consumers' awareness of fashion brands intentionally deceiving or misrepresenting their sustainability efforts.

2.2.4. Sustainable Label Awareness

In the context of growing concern for environmental issues and responsible consumption, sustainability labels have become an important communication tool to guide consumer behavior. This concept refers to information, symbols, logos, or visual signals printed or attached directly to packaging and products, with the purpose of providing consumers with information about the product's sustainable attributes, including environmental, social, and ethical aspects (Majer, Henscher, Reuber, Fischer-Kreer, & Fischer, 2022). Unlike traditional advertising, sustainability labels focus on enhancing product transparency, helping consumers easily identify and distinguish environmentally friendly products in a market filled with hard-to-verify marketing claims. In the fashion industry, these labels often include information about material origins, emissions, labor conditions, recyclability, and product life cycle.

Recent studies have expanded this concept to include digital labels such as QR codes and electronic traceability systems. These are seen as solutions to enhance transparency, reliability, and the verifiability of sustainability information throughout the value chain (Yadav & Kar, 2024). This is particularly important in the fashion industry, where greenwashing is a prominent issue, because high transparency strengthens trust and increases the likelihood of converting intention into actual purchasing behavior, communicating commitments and sustainable practices such as environmental, social,

ethical, product life cycle, thereby enhancing consumer confidence and promoting responsible consumption.

Besides content, the way information is presented on the label is also a critical factor affecting consumer reception and trust. Williams, Hodges, and Watchravesringkan (2023) emphasize that label design must consider the consumer's perspective, including comprehensibility, visual appeal, and the ability to compare information to maximize communication effectiveness. Furthermore, according to Yadav and Kar (2025), sustainability labels are not just a source of information but also a psychological trigger that helps reinforce personal beliefs and values (such as minimalism), thereby promoting sustainable consumption intentions and behaviors.

2.3. Literature Review

This table summarizes 11 representative research studies related to the factors influencing minimalist lifestyles and sustainable fashion consumption trends. Each study is described based on the following criteria: (1) Article Title, (2) Author(s), (3) Journal of Publication, (4) Independent Variables (denoted X1-X8), (5) Dependent Variable (denoted Y), (6) Mediating Variables (denoted Z1-Z3), (7) Research Type, and (8) Summary of Research Findings. All selected articles are reputable international scientific publications, published in Q1 or Q2 journals according to the Scimago research quality classification, ensuring high academic reliability. In the research findings section (8), the team has clearly presented the relationships between the variables in the model, indicated by a “+” sign (for a positive relationship) or a “-” sign (for a negative relationship). Additionally, the research hypotheses are evaluated based on p-values or critical values: if less than 0.05, the relationship is considered statistically significant and is accepted; otherwise, it is rejected.

Table 2.3. Related Studies

No.	Article Title	Author(s)	Journal	Independent Variable(s) (X)	Dependent Variable (Y)	Mediating Variable(s) (Z)	Research Type	Findings/Results
1.	How environmental	Daniel K. Maduku	Journal of Retailing	Environmental concern	Sustainable consumption intention	Anticipated positive emotions,	Quantitative	EC → APE ($\beta = 0.515$, $t = 12.604$, $p < 0.001$) (Supported) EC → ANE ($\beta = 0.363$, $t = 8.934$,

	concerns influence consumers' anticipated emotions towards sustainable consumption: The moderating role of regulatory focus		and Consumer Services			Anticipated negative emotions		$p < 0.001$) (Supported) $EC \rightarrow SCI$ ($\beta = 0.575$, $t = 12.415$, $p < 0.001$) (Supported) $APE \rightarrow SCI$ ($\beta = 0.201$, $t = 5.543$, $p < 0.001$) (Supported) $ANE \rightarrow SCI$ ($\beta = 0.122$, $t = 3.684$, $p < 0.001$) (Supported) $APE \times Promotion\ Focus \rightarrow SCI$ ($\beta = 0.187$, $t = 3.684$, $p < 0.001$) (Supported) $ANE \times Promotion\ Focus \rightarrow SCI$ ($\beta = -0.173$, $t = -4.596$, $p < 0.001$) (Supported) $APE \times Prevention\ Focus \rightarrow SCI$ ($\beta = -0.174$, $t = -4.331$, $p < 0.001$) (Supported) $ANE \times Prevention\ Focus \rightarrow SCI$ ($\beta = 0.077$, $t = 2.197$, $p < 0.05$) (Supported)
--	---	--	-----------------------	--	--	-------------------------------	--	--

2.	Factors affecting sustainable consumption behavior: Roles of pandemics and perceived consumer effectiveness	Tri Cao Minh, Nga Nguyen Thi Quynh	Cleaner and Responsible Consumption	Pandemics	Sustainable Consumption Behavior	Environmental Concern, Attitude, Subjective Norms, Perceived Behavioral Control, Personal Norms, Sustainable Intention	Qualitative, Quantitative	PAN $\rightarrow$ EC ($\beta = 0.424$; $p < 0.05$) (Supported) PAN $\rightarrow$ ATT ($\beta = 0.343$; $p < 0.05$) (Supported) PAN $\rightarrow$ SN ($\beta = 0.364$; $p < 0.05$) (Supported) PAN $\rightarrow$ PBC ($\beta = 0.387$ and $p < 0.05$) (Supported) PAN $\rightarrow$ PN ($\beta = 0.411$ and $p < 0.05$) (Supported) EC $\rightarrow$ SI ($\beta = 0.129$, $p < 0.05$) (Supported) ATT $\rightarrow$ SI ($\beta = 0.221$, $p < 0.05$) (Supported) SN $\rightarrow$ SI ($\beta = -0.078$, $p = 0.073 > 0.05$) (Rejected) PBC $\rightarrow$ SI ($\beta = 0.301$; $p < 0.05$) (Supported)
----	---	------------------------------------	-------------------------------------	-----------	----------------------------------	--	---------------------------	---

								PN $\rightarrow$ SI ($\beta = 0.393$ and $p < 0.05$) (Supported) SI $\rightarrow$ SCB ($\beta = -0.078$, $p = 0.073 > 0.05$) (Rejected) SI x PCE $\rightarrow$ SCB (P-value < 0.05, $\beta = 0.092$) (Supported)
3.	Investigating the antecedents of consumer behavioral intention for sustainable fashion products: Evidence from a	Rosa Maria Dangelico, Letizia Alvino, Luca Fraccascia	Technological Forecasting and Social Change	Determinants (Environmental concern, Product perceived value, Indirect experience, Direct experience	Consumer behavioral intention for sustainable clothing (Purchase intention, Willingness to pay a premium price)		Quantitative	EC $\rightarrow$ PI (Supported) EC $\rightarrow$ PI (Supported) PV $\rightarrow$ PI (Supported) PV $\rightarrow$ WTP (Supported) Direct experience $\rightarrow$ PI (Rejected) $\rightarrow$ WTP (Rejected) DE $\rightarrow$ WTP (Rejected)

	large survey of Italian consumers			ce)				
4.	Analyzing the impact of Covid - 19 on sustainable fashion consumption with a model based on consumer value perceptions	Nazan Okur, Canan Saricam Conan Saricam, Aleyna Rumeysa Iri, Irem Sari	Journal of Fashion Marketing and Management	Environmental concern	Purchase Intention	Environmental knowledge, Perceived price value, Perceived emotional value, Perceived social value, Perceived quality value.	Quantitative	EC → EK (Supported) EK → PQV (Supported) EK → PPV (Supported) EK → PEV (Supported) EK → PSV (Supported) PQV → PI (Rejected) PPV → PI (Rejected) PSV → PI (Supported) PEV → PI (Supported)

5.	Influence of religious value and minimalism on repurchase intention of sustainable fashion: A combined PLS-SEM and NCA approach	Sher Singh Yadav, Sanjay Kumar Kar	Journal of Cleaner Production	Word of Mouth, Sustainable Label Awareness, Circular Economy, SDG Awareness, Greenwashing	Repurchase Intention	Sustainable Fashion Choice Motive, Religious Value, Minimalism	Quantitative	WOM→SFCM (Supported) SLAW→SFCM (Supported) CESDG Awareness→SFCM (Supported) GW→SFCM (Rejected) WOM→RV (Supported)' SLAW→RV (Supported) CESDG Awareness→RV (Rejected) Greenwashing→RV (Supported) WOM→MIN (Rejected) SLAW→MIN (Supported) CESDG Awareness→MIN (Supported) GW→MIN(Supported) SFCM→RI (Supported)

								RV→RI (Supported) MI→RI (Rejected)
6.	The influence of greenwashing perception on green purchasing intentions : The mediating role of green word-of-mouth and	Lu Zhang , Dayuan Li, Cuicui Cao, Senhua Huang	Journal of Cleaner Production	Greenwashing perception	Green purchasing intentions	Green WOM, Green concern	Quantitative	GWP → GPI ($\beta = - 0.361$, $p < 0.01$) (Supported) GWP → WOM ($\beta = - 0.335$, $p < 0.01$) (Supported) WOM → GPI ($\beta = - 0.543$, $p < 0.01$) (Supported) GWP → GPI ($\beta = - 0.202$, $p < 0.01$) (Supported)

	moderating role of green concern							
7.	Minimalistic consumption practices and well-being among generation Z: exploring mediating role of satisfaction and happiness	Vijay Kumar Jain, Varghese Joy, Preeti Sharma	Environment Development and Sustainability	Less number of possessions, Sparse aesthetics, Mindfully curated consumption	Minimalism, Satisfaction, Happiness	Well-being	Quantitative	$NOP \rightarrow MIN$ ($\beta = 0.056$, $p < 0.05$) (Supported) $SAF \rightarrow MIN$ ($\beta = 0.55$, $p < 0.05$) (Supported) $MCC \rightarrow MIN$ ($\beta = 0.11$, $p < 0.05$) (Supported) $MIN \rightarrow WB$ ($\beta = 0.24$, $p < 0.001$) (Supported) $MIN \rightarrow SAF \rightarrow WB$ ($\beta = 0.16$, $p < 0.05$) (Supported) $MIN \rightarrow HA \rightarrow WB$ ($\beta = 0.22$, $p < 0.05$) (Supported)

8.	“Less Is More” for Health: How Minimalism Reshapes Food Consumption Patterns and Preferences	Eda Sayin, Sumit Lamik	Psychology & Marketing	Minimalism	Food consumption preferences, Consumption amount	Internal conflict, Strength of desire	Quantitative	Minimalism $\rightarrow$ M1 ($\beta = 8.71$, $p < 0.05$) (Supported) Food-type x Minimalism $\rightarrow$ M1 ($\beta = -13.01$, $p = 0.05$) (Supported) Minimalism $\rightarrow$ Strength of desire ($\beta = 23.75$, $SE = 5.72$, $p < 0.01$) (Supported) Minimalism $\rightarrow$ food preferences (Supported)
9.	Consumer minimalism for sustainability: Exploring	Yupal Shukla, Sita Mishra, Ravi Chatterjee,	Journal of Consumer Behaviour	Familiarity, Perceived Reputation,	Retail Consumption Intention	Consumer Minimalism	Quantitative	FM $\rightarrow$ RCI ($\beta = 0.52$, $p < 0.001$) (Supported) PR $\rightarrow$ RCI ($\beta = 0.48$, $p < 0.001$) (Supported) PCE $\rightarrow$ RCI ($\beta = 0.06$, $p > 0.05$)

	the determinants of rental consumption intention	Vibha Arora		Perceived Consumer Effectiveness, Ascription of Responsibility				(Rejected) $AR \rightarrow RCI (\beta = 0.47, p < 0.001)$ (Supported) $FM \rightarrow CM \rightarrow RCI$ (Supported) $PR \rightarrow CM \rightarrow RCI$ (Supported) $PCE \rightarrow CM \rightarrow RCI$ (Supported) $PCE \rightarrow CM \rightarrow RCI$ (Supported) $AR \rightarrow CM \rightarrow RCI$ (Supported)
10.	Less is more! A pathway to consumers' transcendence	Trang Thi-Thuy Duong, Liem Viet Ngo, Jiraporn Surachartkumtonkun, Mai Dong	Journal of Retailing and Consumer Services	Minimalism	Perceived transcendence	Moral Identity	Quantitative	Model 1: $\text{Minimalism} \rightarrow \text{perceived transcendence} (\beta = 0.65, p < 0.001)$ Model 2: $\text{Moral identity} \times \text{Minimalism} \rightarrow \text{Perceived transcendence} (\beta = 0.16, p < 0.001)$ (Supported) $\text{Minimalism} \rightarrow \text{moral identity} (\beta =$

		Tran, Gavin Northey						0.47, $p < 0.001$) (Supported) Moral identity $\rightarrow$ perceived transcendence ($\beta = 0.34$, $p < 0.001$) (Supported) Minimalism $\rightarrow$ perceived transcendence ($\beta = 0.49$, $p < 0.001$)
11.	Understanding the Predictors of Sustainable Food Consumption Behavior: A Pathway to	Vivek Thakur, Shampy Kamboj, Mohd Adil	Sustainable Development	Consequence perception	Acquisition, Usage, Disposal	Responsibility attribution, Consumer attitude, Individual norms, Consumer minimalism, Sustainable intention.	Quantitative	CP $\rightarrow$ RA ($\beta = 0.526$, $p < 0.001$) CP $\rightarrow$ IN ($\beta = 0.601$, $p < 0.001$) (Supported) RA $\rightarrow$ IN ($\beta = 0.187$, $p < 0.001$) (Supported) CP $\rightarrow$ CA ($\beta = 0.290$, $p < 0.001$) (Supported) IN $\rightarrow$ CA ($\beta = 0.287$, $p < 0.001$) (Supported) IN $\rightarrow$ CM ($\beta = 0.412$, $p < 0.001$) (Supported)

	Achieving Sustainable Development Goals							CA $\rightarrow$ SI ($\beta = 0.148$, $p < 0.05$) (Supported) CM $\rightarrow$ SI ($\beta = 0.424$, $p < 0.001$) (Supported) SI $\rightarrow$ AC ($\beta = 0.595$, $p < 0.001$) (Supported) SI $\rightarrow$ US ($\beta = 0.115$, $p < 0.05$) (Supported) SI $\rightarrow$ DS ($\beta = 0.489$, $p < 0.001$) (Supported)
--	---	--	--	--	--	--	--	---

2.4. Proposed Hypotheses and Research Model

2.4.1. The relationship between Simple Aesthetics and Minimalism

According to Wilson, and Bellezza (2024), minimalist aesthetics are defined by minimalistic areas, items, and collections, often characterized by simple design, clean lines, minimal decoration, and a monochromatic color palette. This approach encourages individuals to eliminate everything superfluous, retaining only what is truly essential (Kamal & Nasir, 2022). In fashion, this translates to decluttering one's wardrobe, removing clothes that no longer fit, and, more importantly, resisting the desire to purchase trendy but non-essential items. This act of selecting and refining a wardrobe brings a efficiency and elegance through the deliberate reduction of components, ultimately being minimalist (Sandlin & Wallin, 2022).

Previous studies have suggested that simple aesthetics are the foundation of minimalism. The research by Martin-Woodhead and Waight (2023) indicated that Minimalism is built upon a foundation of minimalist aesthetic distinguished by simplicity, moderation, and the intentional removal of non-essential elements. Similarly, Wilson and Bellezza (2022) and Laaksonen (2024) also concluded that Minimalism is conceptualized as a three-dimensional reflective-formative construct: intentionally selected consumption, the number of possessions, and simple aesthetics. Like the studies above Jain, Joy, and Sharma (2024) stated that Minimalism here is defined as a concept that includes the removal of non-essentials, intentional consumption, simple aesthetics, financial freedom, and a sustainable lifestyle. In summary, a key commonality of these studies is that they view simple aesthetics as an attribute, a characteristic, or a preference of someone who is already a minimalist. These studies describe a static state: if you are a minimalist, you tend to prefer simple aesthetics. Differing from these studies, the pioneering research by Jain, Joy, and Sharma (2024) demonstrated that simple aesthetics have a positive impact on minimalism, with a Beta coefficient of 0.553. Recognizing this distinction, our subsequent research direction will be to replicate and evaluate this relationship in a new environment and

context: Ho Chi Minh City. Based on these arguments, the authors propose the following hypothesis:

H1: Simple aesthetics have a positive impact on minimalism.

2.4.2. The relationship between Greenwashing Perception and Minimalism

The phenomenon of greenwashing has become a prominent issue in the fashion industry, with many brands using "green" marketing strategies without concrete evidence. According to Adamkiewicz, Kochanska, Adamkiewicz, and Łukasik (2022), greenwashing not only distorts consumer perception but also hinders the development of sustainable fashion. The ambiguity and exaggeration in sustainability claims make consumers increasingly skeptical, leading to a decline in brand trust (Alizadeh, Liscio, & Sospiro, 2024). For example, H&M once labeled a product line "Conscious" without demonstrating specific environmental benefits, causing widespread controversy and raising concerns about transparency in green communication (Kaner, 2021). According to Paudel (2024), both Generation X and Y exhibit higher levels of skepticism as their perception of greenwashing increases, resulting in a reduced purchase intention for sustainable fashion.

From the perspective of Brehm's (1966) Psychological Reactance Theory (PRT), individuals have a need to maintain their cognitive and behavioral freedom. When they feel manipulated by dishonest communication campaigns, they experience reactance, manifested through avoidance, opposition, or seeking alternatives to restore a sense of control (Brehm & Brehm, 1981). In this context, minimalism can be seen as a form of resistant consumer behavior.

According to Wilson and Bellezza (2022), minimalism is a life philosophy oriented towards simplicity, valuing spiritual well-being, freedom, and authenticity, while also expressing an attitude of resistance against materialism and conspicuous consumption. When consumers perceive greenwashing, they may feel their ethical values are being exploited for commercial purposes, leading to psychological reactance. Consequently, they reject "fake green" products and shift to a consumption style that expresses autonomy such

as minimalist fashion, which emphasizes genuine sustainability, individuality, and control over choices. Based on these arguments, the authors propose the following hypothesis:

H2: Greenwashing Perception has a positive impact on the tendency to pursue Minimalism.

2.4.3. The relationship between Sustainable Label Awareness and Minimalism

Sustainable labels often serve as an indicator of quality. For example, a textile product with GOTS (Global Organic Textile Standard) certification not only guarantees the origin of the fibers but also a strict production process, which often corresponds to higher durability. Eco-labels are therefore considered an effective tool to help consumers identify environmentally friendly products and support them in making sustainable purchasing decisions (Jimenez-Fernandez, Aramendía-Muneta, & Alzate, 2023). When consumers have a high awareness of sustainable labels, they not only increase their behavioral intention towards green products (Bezençon & Etemad-Sajadi, 2015) but also tend to adjust their lifestyle and consumption behavior towards being more selective, focusing on use-value, and reducing excess. Therefore, with awareness of these labels, minimalist consumers can more easily identify and choose products that align with the "less is more" philosophy. The study by Sher Singh Yadav and Sanjay Kumar Kar (2025) also shows that awareness of sustainable labels positively impacts minimalism. However, this relationship has not been extensively explored in previous research. Therefore, the research team will include it in the model to enhance novelty when testing it in the context of Ho Chi Minh City. These are the core characteristics of minimalism: valuing simplicity, limiting overconsumption, and moving towards sustainable, long-lasting choices. Based on this, the research team proposes the hypothesis:

H3: Sustainable Label Awareness has a positive impact on Minimalism.

2.4.4. The relationship between Environmental Concern and Minimalism

Environmental concern is understood as an individual's level of awareness, anxiety, and willingness to act to protect the environment (Dunlap & Jones, 2002). Some studies suggest that minimalists often have environmental concerns (Herziger, Berkessel, &

Steinnes, 2020; Martin-Woodhead, 2021). The Theory of Planned Behavior (Ajzen, 1991) states that a positive attitude towards the environment, formed from personal awareness and values, will result in a desire to perform environmentally friendly behaviors. Furthermore, The Norm-Activation Theory (Schwartz, 1977) states that individuals with high environmental concern often develop a sense of moral responsibility towards nature, which in turn motivates them to choose a simple lifestyle and controlled consumption (Blackburn, Leviston, & Walker, 2025).

Recent studies also provide empirical evidence supporting this relationship. Blackburn, Leviston and Walker (2025) showed that environmental concern is the key driver for low - consumption lifestyles such as minimalism and voluntary simplicity. Similarly, Jain, Joy and Sharma (2024) affirmed that people with high ecological consciousness are more likely to adopt a minimalist lifestyle because they see it as a way to lessen their adverse environmental effects. The Şener, Bişkin, and Dündar (2022) found that environmental issues were found to have a stronger impact on purchase intention, despite showing only a slight positive impact on customers' attitudes toward sustainable fashion consumption. Balderjahn, Seegebarth, and Lee (2020) also found that sustainability awareness significantly influences the trend of consumption reduction, emphasizing the role of ecological values in shaping lifestyle choices.

From these theoretical foundations and empirical evidence, it can be seen that environmental concern not only shapes a positive attitude towards environmental protection behaviors but also motivates individuals to adjust their fashion consumption habits, moving towards a more minimalist and sustainable daily life. Based on these arguments, the authors propose the hypothesis:

H4: Environmental concern has a positive impact on the tendency to pursue Minimalism.

2.4.5. The relationship between Price Perception and Minimalism

Price is understood as a unit of value that consumers exchange for the right to own and use a product or service to benefit from it. Price has long been considered a crucial

signal in the consumer decision-making process, not only reflecting affordability but also shaping how consumers evaluate product value (Zeithaml, 1988). According to Kotler and Armstrong (2018), price perception includes two aspects: price attractiveness (the consumer's opinion of the offered price) and price fairness (the degree to which the cost appropriately represents the advantages that the good or service offers). According to Perceived Value Theory, purchase decisions are influenced not just by the absolute price but by the comparison between perceived value and the cost incurred. When consumers have a high price perception, they tend to consider the total lifecycle cost, long-term use-value, and financial efficiency rather than just the initial purchase price. This leads to a shift from short-term consumption to more strategic and sustainable consumption behaviors.

In this context, minimalism has emerged as a consumption trend that emphasizes necessity, quality, and durability, helping consumers reduce excess spending and optimize use-value. Recent studies show that a minimalist lifestyle not only brings financial benefits but also enhances consumers' happiness and mental well-being (Blackburn, Leviston, & Walker, 2025). Particularly in the fashion industry, the "buy-use-dispose" consumption model has created a short-term consumption loop, pushing consumers into a state of repeated financial drain due to constant product replacement. Although these products have a low initial price, their actual total cost of ownership is much higher than that of high-quality, long-lifespan products. When consumers become aware of this disparity, their approach to consumption behavior changes from focusing on short-term benefits to emphasizing long-term financial efficiency. Minimalism in consumption is the trend of selectively choosing products, prioritizing quality, necessity, and durability, rather than shopping based on quantity or fleeting trends. The minimalist lifestyle emphasizes "less but better" while minimizing waste and optimizing the use-value of products. Based on the theoretical and empirical arguments above, this study proposes:

H5: Price perception has a positive impact on the tendency to pursue Minimalism.

2.4.6. The relationship between Environmental Concern and Sustainable Fashion Consumption Intention

Environmental concern can be seen as an attitude or value orientation that reflects consumers' beliefs about the relationship between humans and nature, particularly regarding the impact of the fashion industry (Fransson & Garling, 1999). Based on Schwartz's (2012) value model and the work of Stern and Dietz (1994), this concern can stem from different values such as egoistic, altruistic, and biospheric, thereby influencing attitudes and behaviors related to fashion consumption.

Research has demonstrated that pro-environmental conduct is frequently significantly predicted by environmental concern and sustainable consumption intention, including in the fashion sector (Yue, Li, Liu, Jin, & Bao, 2020). Particularly in the post-COVID-19 context, issues such as pollution from the textile industry and resource waste have become urgent, making consumers more aware of the importance of responsible fashion consumption behavior (Sarmadi, Rahimi, Evensen, & Kazemi Moghaddam, 2021). Consequently, environmental concern has increasingly become a key driver, motivating consumers to seek and choose green, environmentally friendly fashion products, as well as to adjust their shopping behavior to limit negative impacts on nature.

Dunlap and Jones (2002) define environmental concern as the extent to which consumers care about and support initiatives to address environmental issues, demonstrated through behaviors such as purchasing green or sustainable fashion products. Many studies also confirm that it is the important predictor of pro-environmental behavior and sustainable consumption intention (Hartmann & Apaolaza-Ibañez, 2012; Yue, Li, Liu, Jin, & Bao, 2020; Rausch & Kopplin, 2021). Specifically, a study by Park & Lin (2020) showed that environmental concern positively influences the intention to purchase recycled and upcycled fashion products. Based on the above results, it is suggested that people with a high level of environmental concern will have a stronger intention for sustainable fashion consumption. Therefore, the research team proposes the following hypothesis:

H6: Environmental concern has a positive impact on consumers' sustainable fashion consumption intention.

2.4.7. The relationship between Price Perception and Sustainable Fashion Consumption Intention

According to Prihatini and Gumilang (2021), price is considered a measure of the value that consumers must give up to own and use a fashion product, thereby receiving desired benefits such as style, self-expression, and quality. In the fashion industry, researchers acknowledge that price plays a pivotal role in determining purchasing behavior (Kalyanaram, Saini, Mony & Jayasankaran, 2022), especially when comparing fast fashion with sustainable fashion. Price is often regarded as one of the most critical factors in fashion marketing and brand management (Unal & Tascioglu, 2022). Consumers always compare the price of a fashion item with other products before making a purchase decision (Ghaffar & Islam, 2023). According to Hride et al. (2021), if customers perceive that the quality, durability, and design offered by a fashion product are high, they will deem the price reasonable and be willing to pay it.

People with ecological concerns tend to be more willing to pay a higher price for environmentally friendly fashion products (Nguyen et al., 2025). Many buyers are even prepared to pay more for sustainable clothing such as clothing made from organic materials or produced ethically if they feel it is worth the value the product offers. According to Okur et al. (2023), the perception of price value has the strongest influence on consumers' purchase intentions. Previous studies also indicate that the perception of price value is a factor that distinctly influences the intention and decision to buy green and sustainable fashion products. The more customers recognize the tangible (durability, good materials) and intangible (environmental protection, support for fair labor) values that a sustainable fashion product provides, the more willing they will be to pay a higher price. Based on the arguments above, the authors propose the following hypothesis:

H7: Price perception has a positive impact on consumers' sustainable fashion consumption intention.

2.4.8. The relationship between Minimalism and the Sustainable Fashion Consumption Intention.

Minimalism is considered a lifestyle orientation that emphasizes restraint, intentionality, and prioritizing quality over quantity in consumption decisions, particularly in the realm of fashion (Wilson & Bellezza, 2021). These characteristics significantly align with the principles of sustainable fashion, which focuses on curbing overconsumption (fast fashion), minimizing textile waste, and encouraging the use of products with longer lifecycles. Therefore, there is a solid theoretical basis to suggest that minimalism can positively influence the intention to consume sustainable fashion.

At a direct level, minimalism shapes the behavior of fashion consumers through three primary mechanisms. First, the “less is more” philosophy encourages the creation of a “capsule wardrobe” minimizing the purchase of superfluous clothing, thereby directly limiting resource extraction and textile waste generation. Second, individuals pursuing a minimalist lifestyle often prioritize the quality and durability of garments over cheap, disposable fast fashion items, thus extending the product lifecycle. Third, they tend to shop cautiously, carefully considering the necessity, versatility, and long-term impact of an item on their personal style and the environment. The research by Deveci and Yıldız (2025) provided empirical evidence for this relationship, showing that factors such as reducing wardrobe clutter, mindful shopping, and prioritizing durability all positively impact sustainable fashion consumption behavior.

At an indirect level, minimalism fosters psychological foundations that reinforce the intention for sustainable fashion consumption. First and foremost, personal consumer effectiveness or the conviction that one's deliberate fashion choices can have a beneficial effect on society and the environment, is increased by minimalism. This belief has been proven to be a crucial mediating factor in promoting sustainable behavioral intentions. Additionally, research by Sayin and Malik (2025) indicates that minimalism enhances self-control, enabling individuals to overcome the temptation of impulsive, trend-driven fashion purchases and make decisions that align with sustainability goals. Furthermore, Laaksonen (2024) shows that minimalist consumers often value and are willing to support the sustainability efforts of fashion brands, such as the use of recycled materials or eco-friendly

product design, while being less influenced by price barriers for these products. Based on the arguments above, the authors propose the following hypothesis:

H8: Minimalism has a positive impact on the intention to consume sustainable fashion.

2.5. Proposed Research Model

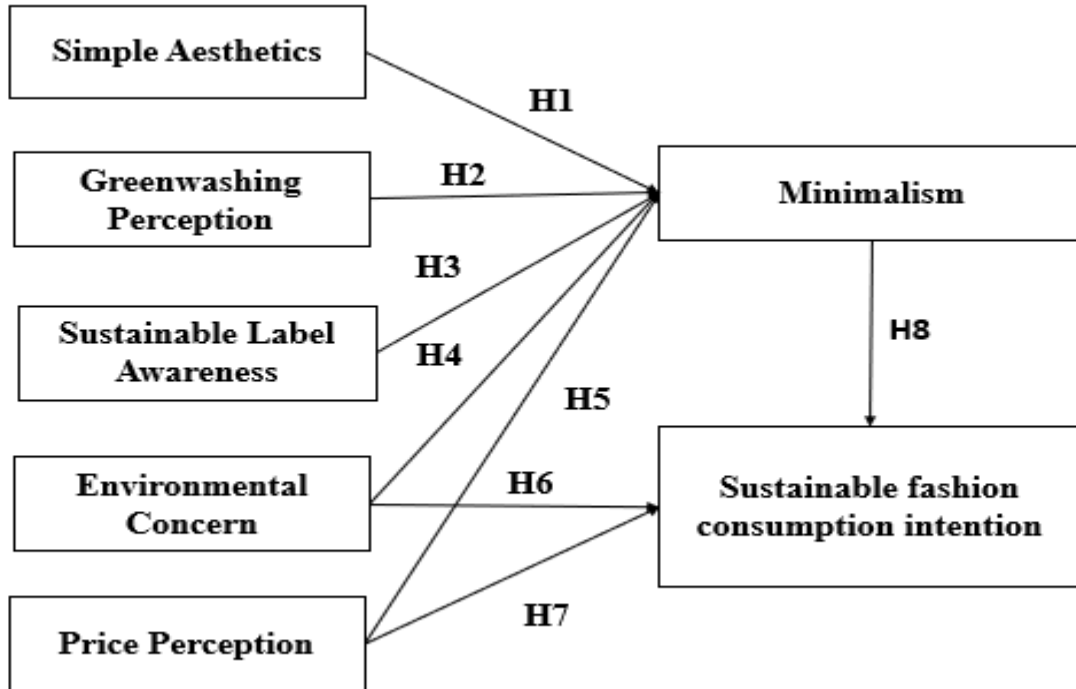


Figure 2. Proposed Research Model

Source: Authors

CHAPTER 3: RESEARCH METHODOLOGY

3.1. Introduction

.The theoretical foundation outlined in Chapter 2 acts as the groundwork for both formulating and presenting the research methodology in Chapter 3

This chapter covers the following main aspects:

- (1) Research methodology
- (2) Research process
- (3) Measurement scales of the concepts
- (4) Sampling method and data collection

3.2. Research Design

3.2.1. Research Methodology

This research utilizes a quantitative approach. The team surveyed consumers in Ho Chi Minh City through a questionnaire featuring a 5-point Likert scale (ranging from 1: "Strongly Disagree" to 5: "Strongly Agree"). After data collection, 354 valid responses were selected for further analysis. The analysis commenced immediately after the official survey data was collected, with the research team proceeding through steps to evaluate the proposed hypotheses.

Descriptive statistics were used to provide an overview of the sample, including characteristics such as gender, age, income, and education level.

To assess the reliability of the scales, Cronbach's Alpha was calculated, applying the standard suggested by Hair et al. (2021), where a value of $\text{Alpha} \geq 0.70$ is considered sufficient. This ensures the consistency and dependability of the measures

Furthermore, the study employs the Partial Least Squares Structural Equation Modeling (PLS-SEM) method. This is a powerful analytical technique capable of identifying and testing the relationships between variables in the research model, and it is particularly suitable for models with complex structures. Previously, such relationships

were often handled through traditional methods like multiple linear regression, logistic regression, or exploratory factor analysis. However, PLS-SEM has a distinct advantage in minimizing biases that can affect the dependent variable while increasing the R^2 value, thereby enhancing the model's predictive power (Hair et al., 2017).

The steps for PLS-SEM analysis are as follows:

Preliminary Analysis: The measurement model is evaluated based on a set of criteria recommended by Hair, Howard, and Nitzl (2019) to ensure its suitability before proceeding with more in-depth analyses.

Measurement Model Assessment: The criteria used include: indicator loadings must be greater than 0.7; Cronbach's Alpha should be within the range of 0.60-0.90; and the Average Variance Extracted (AVE) must be at least 0.50 to confirm convergent validity. The AVE index reflects the extent to which the variance of the observed variables is explained by their corresponding latent factor.

Discriminant Validity Assessment: Following the method of Henseler et al. (2015), the heterotrait-monotrait ratio (HTMT) is used to check for discriminant validity between constructs. The recommended HTMT threshold is ≤ 0.90 for constructs that are conceptually similar and ≤ 0.85 for constructs that are conceptually distinct.

Structural Model Assessment: After the measurement model is confirmed, the structural model is examined. First, the Variance Inflation Factor (VIF) is checked to detect multicollinearity, with an ideal VIF value being ≤ 5 . Next, the R^2 and f^2 indices are calculated to determine the effect size of the independent variables on the dependent variable and to assess whether these variables enhance or diminish the model's predictive power.

Hypothesis Testing: Finally, the bootstrapping method is used to determine the statistical significance of the path coefficients and other parameters in the model. A hypothesis is accepted if the p-value is less than 0.05 or if the 95% confidence interval does not contain zero.

3.2.2. Research Process

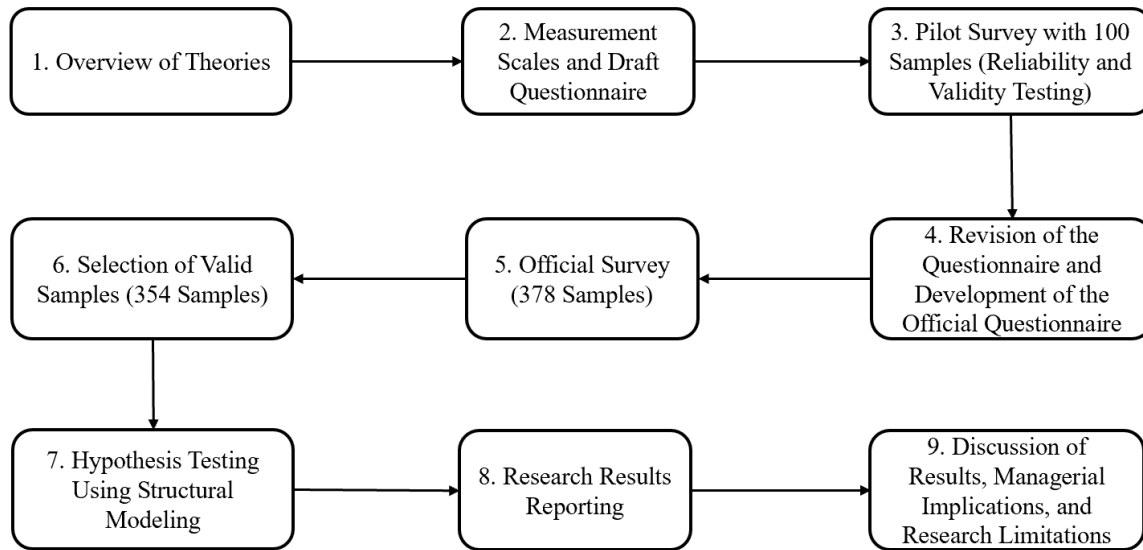


Figure 3. Research Process Design

Source: Authors

3.3. Measurement Scales

The author adapted the wording of original scales from earlier research to align with the specific context of the study in Ho Chi Minh City, Vietnam. After considering prior research and the local setting, the author opted for a 5-point Likert scale in the questionnaire. Consequently, respondents' level of agreement is measured on a scale from 1 to 5, where a higher score signifies stronger agreement with the given statement. The 5-point Likert scale is defined as:

- 1: Strongly Disagree
- 2: Disagree
- 3: Neutral
- 4: Agree
- 5: Strongly Agree

3.3.1. Measurement Scale for Simple Aesthetic

The measurement scale for the Simple Aesthetic construct was developed based on the original scale by Jain, Joy, and Sharma (2024) combined with the research team's proposals. The scale comprises four observed variables, denoted from SA1 to SA4.

SA1: I prefer simple, sophisticated designs in a minimalist style.

SA2: I believe that choosing minimalist fashion helps reduce resource waste in the garment industry.

SA3: I buy fewer clothes but focus on quality and timeless aesthetic appeal.

SA4: I believe that pursuing minimalist fashion is a practical way to support sustainability.

3.3.2. Measurement Scale for Greenwashing Perception

The measurement instrument for the Greenwashing Perception construct was created by adapting the original scale developed by Zhang, Li, Cao, and Huang (2018) and incorporating input from the research team. This scale consists of five observed variables, designated GW1 to GW5.

GW1: I notice many fashion products use misleading language about their environmental friendliness.

GW2: I feel that advertising images (e.g., images of nature, plants) are often overused by fashion brands to create a "green" impression of the product.

GW3: I feel that the "sustainable" claims of many fashion brands are often vague and lack specific evidence.

GW4: I believe that fashion brands often exaggerate the actual environmental benefits that their products provide.

GW5: I believe that fashion brands often conceal important information to make their products seem "greener" than they actually are.

3.3.3. Measurement Scale for Sustainable Label Awareness

The measurement scale for the Sustainable Label Awareness construct was developed based on the original scale by Yadav and Kar (2025) combined with the research team's proposals. The scale comprises three observed variables, denoted from LA1 to LA3.

LA1: I believe I correctly understand the meaning of the "sustainable" label on clothing.

LA2: I recognize labels for clothing made from recycled materials.

LA3: When shopping, I often pay attention to the information on clothing labels.

3.3.4. Measurement Scale for Environmental Concern

The scale for the environmental concern variable was developed based on the original scale by D'Souza, Gilmore, Hartmann, Apaolaza Ibáñez, and Sullivan-Mort (2015) with adaptations by the research team. The scale consists of 3 observed variables, denoted from EC1 to EC3.

EC1: I am concerned about issues related to the environment.

EC2: I am willing to change my consumption habits to contribute to environmental protection.

EC3: Protecting the natural environment helps improve my quality of life.

3.3.5. Measurement Scale for Price Perception

The scale for the price perception variable was developed based on the original scale by Walsh, Shiu, and Hassan (2014) with adaptations by the research team. The scale consists of 4 observed variables, denoted from PP1 to PP4.

PP1: I believe that using sustainable fashion products is an economical choice in the long run.

PP2: I find that sustainable fashion products have a reasonable price.

PP3: I think that sustainable fashion products offer value for the money spent.

PP4: I think the price of sustainable fashion is appropriate for the product quality.

3.3.6. Measurement Scale for Minimalism

The scale for the minimalism variable was developed based on the original scale by Iwata (2006) with adaptations by the research team. The scale consists of 4 observed variables, denoted from MN1 to MN4.

MN1: I try to live modestly and avoid buying unnecessary goods.

MN2: When shopping, I carefully consider whether the item is necessary for me.

MN3: Even if I have the money, I do not make impulse purchases.

MN4: I try to use up every item I own.

3.3.7. Measurement Scale for Sustainable Fashion Consumption Intention

The scale for the sustainable fashion consumption intention variable was developed based on the original scales by Cho, Ko, and Borenstein (2024) with adaptations by the research team. The scale consists of 5 observed variables, denoted from FI1 to FI5.

FI1: I will share positive things about shopping for sustainable fashion with others.

FI2: I am willing to buy sustainable fashion products.

FI3: I will recommend sustainable fashion products to my friends.

FI4: I will buy sustainable fashion products for my friends or family.

FI5: I am willing to counter criticism about sustainable fashion.

3.4. Sample size

The determination of the sample size for this study was crucial to ensure the accuracy and methodological integrity of the analysis conducted with Partial Least Squares Structural Equation Modeling (PLS-SEM). Based on the recommendations of Hair et al. (2021), the minimum required sample size was computed using the formula $(\text{minimum } 2.486/\beta)^2$ to achieve a 5% statistical significance level and identify a minimum path coefficient (β) within the 0.11-0.20 range.

For this research, a minimum detectable path coefficient of $\beta = 0.20$ was established at a 5% significance level, which resulted in a calculated minimum sample requirement of

155 participants. In practice, data was gathered from 378 individuals. After filtering out 24 incomplete or invalid submissions, the final dataset comprised 354 valid responses. This final sample size not only satisfied the validity criteria for the research but also surpassed the minimum requirement, thus ensuring sufficient statistical power and improving the potential to generalize the study's conclusions.

Adhering to the sample size guidelines from Hair et al. serves a dual purpose: it validates the scientific precision of the research approach and enhances the trustworthiness and dependability of the empirical findings derived from this investigation.

3.5. Summary

Chapter 3 of this thesis is dedicated to a detailed presentation of the research methodology, emphasizing the quantitative approach to guarantee that data collection and analysis were performed with scientific rigor. The primary aim of this chapter is to offer a transparent account of the procedures followed to meet the research objectives.

The study employed a quantitative strategy, carrying out a large-scale survey. Data was gathered using a convenience sampling technique, resulting in 354 valid survey responses from the target consumer demographic in Ho Chi Minh City. The surveys were administered and collected via both online channels (digital platforms) and traditional offline methods. Upon completion of the data collection phase, the entire dataset was compiled and analyzed using SmartPLS 4.0 software. This specialized tool was utilized to test the proposed hypotheses and assess the relationships among the variables. The goal of this analytical process was to generate dependable findings, thereby establishing a robust basis for the conclusions and recommendations presented in the subsequent chapters.

CHAPTER 4: RESEARCH RESULTS

4.1. Descriptive statistics

After collecting data through a quantitative questionnaire deployed on the Google Forms platform, the study recorded a total of 378 responses. The data processing involved checking and removing invalid responses, resulting in 354 qualified responses retained for in-depth analysis. The data was coded and processed using the SMART PLS 4.0 software to perform subsequent quantitative analyses, ensuring accuracy and scientific rigor in testing the research hypotheses. Table 4.1 below summarizes the demographic characteristics of the study participants, such as their gender, age, and education level, and average monthly income.

Table 4.1. Descriptive Statistics of Survey Participants

Characteristic	Category	Frequency	Percentage
Gender	Male	143	40,4%
	Female	211	59,6%
Age	Under 18 years old	13	3,7%
	From 18 to 27 years old	187	52,8%
	From 28 to 37 years old	79	22,3%
	From 38 to 47 years old	46	13,0%
	Over 47 years old	29	8,2%
Education Level	High School	25	7,1%

	University/College	257	72,6%
	Postgraduate	72	20,3%
Income	Less than 5 million VND/month	29	8,2%
	From 5 to less than 10 million VND/month	112	31,6%
	From 10 to less than 15 million VND/month	109	30,8%
	Over 15 million VND/month	104	29,4%

Source: Summary from the authors

Gender

Of the 354 survey participants, males accounted for 40.4% (143 individuals), while females made up a higher proportion at 59.6% (211 individuals). This disparity reflects a greater interest among females in topics related to minimalism and sustainable consumption. This result can be explained by the psychological and consumer behavior characteristics of females, who often prioritize factors such as aesthetics, lifestyle balance, and social responsibility in their purchasing decisions.

Age

The age distribution of the survey sample shows that the 18-27 age group accounted for the highest proportion at 52.8% (187 individuals), followed by the 28-37 age group at 22.3% (79 individuals), the 38-47 age group at 13.0% (46 individuals), the over 47 age group at 8.2% (29 individuals), and the under 18 age group with the lowest proportion at 3.7% (13 individuals). This age structure shows that most participants in the survey are young people, who are considered dynamic, accessible, and highly aware of sustainable living trends.

Education Level

Regarding educational level, 72.6% (257 individuals) of participants had a college or university degree, followed by those with postgraduate education at 20.3% (72 individuals), and 7.1% (25 individuals) of participants who had a high school education. This characteristic indicates that the research sample has a relatively high educational level, contributing to their ability to understand and evaluate complex concepts such as “minimalism” and “sustainable consumption” thereby improving the trustworthiness of the collected data.

Income

In terms of income, the group earning between 5 and under 10 million VND per month made up the largest proportion at 31.6% (112 individuals), followed by the group with 10 to under 15 million VND/month at 30.8% (109 individuals), the group with over 15 million VND/month at 29.4% (104 individuals), and the group with under 5 million VND/month with the lowest proportion at 8.2% (29 individuals). This income structure reflects that the survey sample mainly includes individuals with middle to relatively high income, consistent with the characteristics of urban consumers in Ho Chi Minh City. This group has stable financial capacity and the potential to access products or services associated with sustainable lifestyles.

4.2. Measurement Model Evaluation

4.2.1. Scale Reliability

After removing unreliable observed variables, it can be seen that all scales achieved Cronbach's alpha values exceeding 0.7, ranging from 0.701 to 0.800. Similarly, all composite reliability values are greater than 0.7. Therefore, these values indicate statistical reliability.

Outer loadings reflect the strength and direction of the association between the observed variables. According to Hair et al. (2021), for an indicator to be considered high quality, its outer loading must be greater than or equal to 0.7 (≥ 0.7). The analysis results indicate that the outer loadings of the indicators GW3, FI5, and MN1 were less than 0.7;

therefore, they were removed from the model as they did not meet the standard requirement. The remaining indicators in this study all satisfy the standard requirement.

From the results collected and analyzed in Table 4.2.1, it is shown that all criteria are met, which proves that the observed variables are of high quality, reliable, and appropriate for inclusion in the model.

Table 4.2.1. Results of Cronbach's Alpha, Composite Reliability, Outer Loadings, and Average Variance Extracted (AVE)

Scale		Cronbach's alpha	Composite Reliability (rho_A)	Composite Reliability (CR)	Outer Loading	Average Variance Extracted (AVE)
PP		0.734	0.734	0.832		0.554
	[PP1]				0.713	
	[PP2]				0.703	
	[PP3]				0.788	
	[PP4]				0.770	
GW		0.745	0.755	0.838		0.565
	[GW1]				0.718	
	[GW2]				0.745	
	[GW3]				0.696	

	[GW4]				0.732	
	[GW5]				0.703	
EC		0.565	0.565	0.565		0.665
	[EC1]				0.775	
	[EC2]				0.812	
	[EC3]				0.857	
LA		0.800	0.808	0.882		0.714
	[LA1]				0.849	
	[LA2]				0.870	
	[LA3]				0.814	
FI		0.790	0.791	0.864		0.613
	[FI1]				0.774	
	[FI2]				0.767	
	[FI3]				0.750	
	[FI4]				0.767	
	[FI5]				0.607	
MN		0.701	0.703	0.833		0.625

	[MN1]				0.699	
	[MN2]				0.745	
	[MN3]				0.791	
	[MN4]				0.745	
SA		0.793	0.802	0.865		0.615
	[SA1]				0.763	
	[SA2]				0.762	
	[SA3]				0.829	
	[SA4]				0.786	

Source: Data processed using SmartPLS 4

4.2.2. Assessment of Convergent Validity

According to Hair et al. (2021), convergent validity is assessed through the Average Variance Extracted (AVE), where values of 0.50 or higher are considered acceptable. In this study, the highest AVE value is 0.714 for the construct of Sustainable Label awareness and the lowest AVE value is 0.554 for Price Perception. This suggests that the constructs account for at least 55.4% of the variation in their corresponding indicators.

4.2.3. Discriminant Validity-Heterotrait-Monotrait Ratio (HTMT)

The Fornell and Larcker (1981) criterion for assessing discriminant validity was initially considered for this study. However, according to Henseler, Ringle, & Sarstedt (2015), this method has limitations due to its lack of a solid statistical foundation, which can lead to inaccuracies in evaluating discriminant validity. Therefore, the research team

chose to use the Heterotrait-Monotrait Ratio (HTMT) index proposed by Henseler, Ringle, and Sarstedt (2015), which is regarded as a more reliable method.

With the HTMT index, discriminant validity is considered established when the coefficients are below the threshold of 0.85. According to the values shown in Table 4.2.3, it can be seen that all pairs of constructs have HTMT coefficients lower than 0.85. Therefore, the measurement model in this research meets the requirement for discriminant validity.

Table 4.2.3. Heterotrait-Monotrait Ratio (HTMT) of the Scales

	PP	GW	EC	LA	FI	MN	SA
PP							
GW	0.208						
EC	0.280	0.545					
LA	0.393	0.573	0.539				
FI	0.595	0.163	0.277	0.394			
MN	0.295	0.408	0.368	0.411	0.396		
SA	0.239	0.523	0.833	0.661	0.142	0.493	

Source: Data processed using SmartPLS 4

4.3. Structural Model Evaluation

4.3.1. Multicollinearity Assessment (VIF)

Multicollinearity in a regression model occurs when two or more independent variables have a strong correlation with one another. This high correlation makes it more complex to estimate and interpret the regression coefficients. Before testing the model, the research team conducted a multicollinearity assessment to determine if this phenomenon exists in the structural model. The Variance Inflation Factor (VIF) is commonly used to detect and evaluate the level of multicollinearity as it reflects the strength of the associations among the independent variables in the model.

According to Hair, Howard, and Nitzl (2019), if the VIF value is less than or equal to 3.0, multicollinearity is considered unlikely to be an issue. In Table 4.3.1, all VIF values are below the 3.0 threshold, which indicates that multicollinearity does not occur. Therefore, the proposed model is considered appropriate.

Table 4.3.1. Multicollinearity Statistics: Variance Inflation Factor (VIF) Results

	PP	GW	EC	LA	FI	MN	SA
PP					1.082	1.114	
GW						1.372	
EC					1.112	1.805	
LA						1.618	
FI							
MN					1.112		
SA						1.980	

Source: Data processed using SmartPLS 4

4.3.2. Coefficient of Determination (R^2 and Adjusted R^2)

The overall structural model was assessed through a bootstrapping technique with 10,000 resamples, which is appropriate when the data are not normally distributed (Streukens & Leroi-Werelds, 2016).

The R^2 and Adjusted R^2 coefficients are used to assess the goodness-of-fit and explanatory power of the independent variables in the research model. According to Hair et al. (2021), the value of R^2 ranges from 0 to 1, where a level of 0.75 represents substantial explanatory power, 0.5 is considered moderate, and 0.25 is weak. In other words, as R^2 approaches 1, the independent variables can explain a large portion of the variance in the dependent variable; conversely, as this value approaches 0, the explanatory power decreases significantly.

However, when more independent variables are added to the model, the R^2 value can be inflated, leading to a biased assessment. Therefore, the Adjusted R^2 coefficient is often used as an alternative because it adjusts for the number of variables in the model, offering a more precise and realistic representation of how the independent variables explain the dependent variable.

Table 4.3.2. R^2 Test Results

	R-square	R-square adjusted
FI	0.261	0.255
MN	0.190	0.178

Source: Data processed using SmartPLS 4

The model yielded R^2 values of 0.190 for MN and 0.261 for FI, respectively. According to Cohen, Cohen, West, and Aiken (2013), these values represent strong explanatory power for both endogenous latent variables within a social science context. The corresponding Adjusted R^2 values (0.178 and 0.255) also confirm the stability of the model after considering the number of predictors.

4.3.3. Effect Size (f^2)

The f^2 index is used to assess the magnitude of the effect of independent variables on the dependent variable. To perform this evaluation, the study applied the criteria from Cohen, Cohen, West, and Aiken (2013). Specifically, an independent variable with an f^2 value below 0.02 has almost no effect on the dependent variable; below 0.15 is considered a weak effect; from 0.15 to 0.35 is a medium effect; and above 0.35 is a strong effect.

Table 4.3.3. Effect Size (f^2) Results

	PP	GW	EC	LA	FI	MN	SA
PP					0.205	0.019	

GW						0.020	
EC					0.007	0.000	
LA						0.004	
FI							
MN					0.044		
SA						0.043	

Source: Data processed using SmartPLS 4

The analysis results show that "Price Perception" (PP) has an f^2 value of 0.205 in its effect on "Sustainable Fashion Consumption Intention" (FI). This represents a medium effect size, reflecting the significant role of the price factor in shaping consumers' sustainable consumption behavior. This result is consistent with the arguments of many previous studies, which suggest that price is both a barrier and an important driver influencing the decision to purchase sustainable products.

The factors GW, EC, LA, and SA have f^2 values ranging from 0.000 to 0.020, indicating a very small or negligible effect. This suggests that while these factors may be theoretically significant, they have not yet exerted a strong practical influence on sustainable consumption behavior. Notably, "Minimalism" (MN) has an f^2 value of 0.044 in its effect on "Sustainable Fashion Consumption Intention" (FI). Although this is still a small effect size, it is higher than the other factors (except for PP), indicating a certain complementary role of the minimalist lifestyle in promoting sustainable consumption behavior. This result reflects an emerging trend: consumers are beginning to care about reducing material excess, consuming selectively, and moving towards sustainable values, even though the current level of influence is not yet strong.

4.3.4. Bootstrapping Test and Assessment of Path Relationship Significance

In this study, we applied the Bootstrapping technique with 354 observations from the survey sample, performing 10,000 resamples to test the significance of the relationships

after the reliability and validity of the measurement scales were confirmed. The results from the bootstrapping test of the research model are presented in Figure 4 below.

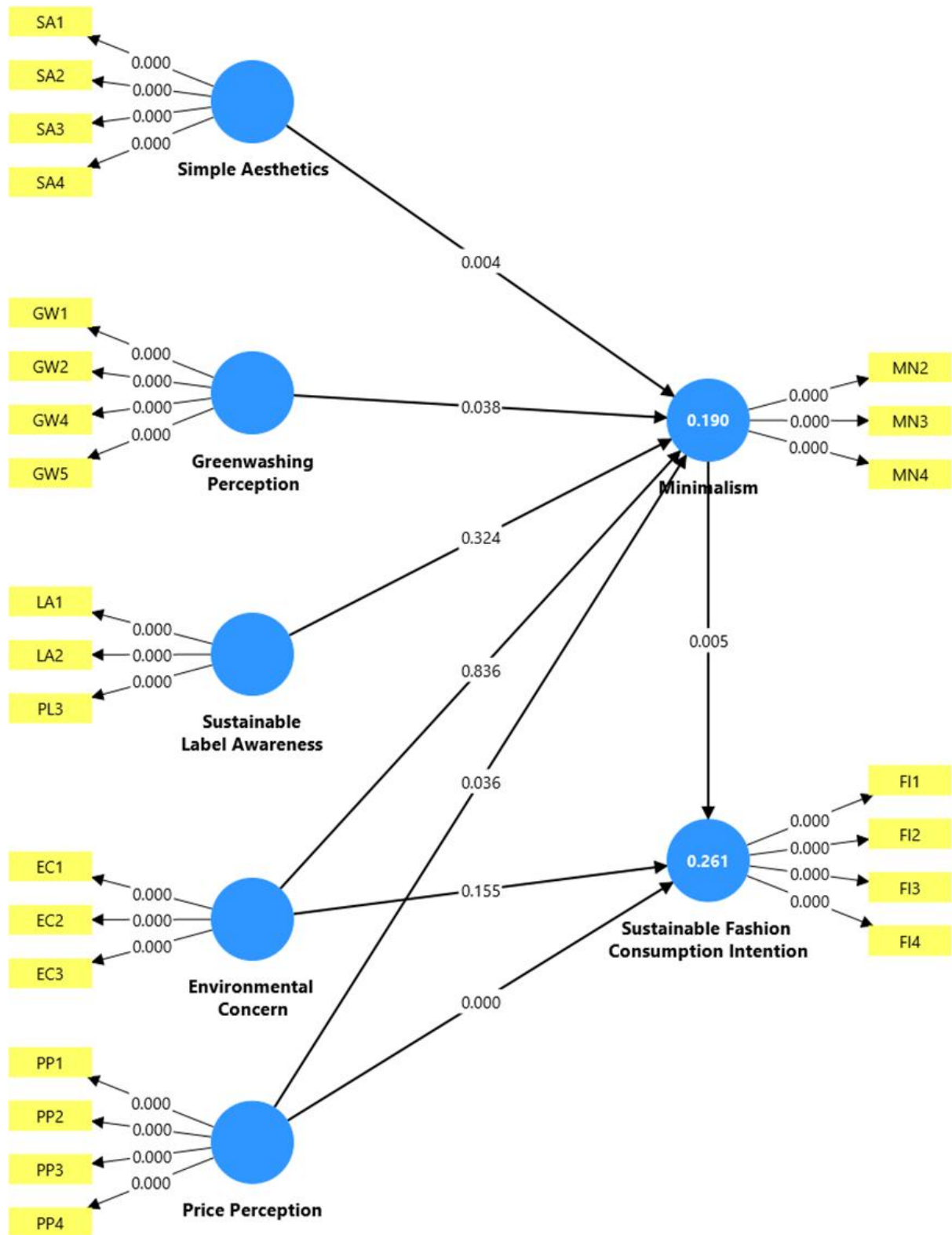


Figure 4. Results of Bootstrapping Test

Ten thousand bootstrap samples were used in the bootstrapping technique. As recommended by Hair et al. (2021), a two-tailed test, the Complete Bootstrapping method with Bias-Corrected and Accelerated (BCa) Bootstrap and a significance level of 0.05 were applied for all other parameters. At a 5% significance level, the critical t-value for a two-tailed test is 1.96. The p-value of the path coefficients must be less than 0.05 or not fall within the 95% confidence interval to be considered significant at a 5% error probability (Hair et al., 2021).

The path coefficient results for the proposed relationships are displayed in Table 4.3.4 below, along with their standard errors and p-values.

Hypothesis H1 proposed that simple aesthetics have a positive influence on minimalism. The test results show that simple aesthetics have a positive influence on minimalism ($\beta=0.263$, $p=0.004 < 0.05$), thus supporting hypothesis H1.

Hypothesis H2 proposed that the greenwashing perception has a positive influence on the minimalism. After testing, the results demonstrate that the greenwashing perception has a positive influence on the tendency to pursue minimalism ($\beta=0.148$, $p=0.038 < 0.05$), thus supporting hypothesis H2.

Hypothesis H5 proposed that price perception has a positive influence on minimalism. After testing, the results indicate that price perception has a positive influence on minimalism ($\beta=0.130$, $p=0.036 < 0.05$), thus supporting hypothesis H5.

Hypothesis H7 proposed that price perception has a positive impact on consumers' sustainable fashion consumption intention. The results show that price perception has a positive impact on consumers' sustainable fashion consumption intention ($\beta=0.404$, $p=0.000 < 0.05$), thus supporting hypothesis H7.

Hypothesis H8 proposed that minimalism has a positive impact on consumers' sustainable consumption intention. The test results indicate that minimalism has a positive impact on consumers' sustainable consumption intention ($\beta=0.191$, $p=0.005 < 0.05$), thus hypothesis H8 is supported.

Hypothesis H3 proposed that the sustainable label awareness has a positive influence on minimalism. However, after testing, the results show that the sustainable label awareness does not have a positive influence on minimalism ($\beta=0.072$, $p=0.324 >0.05$), thus hypothesis H3 is rejected.

Hypothesis H4 proposed that environmental concern has a positive impact on minimalism. But after testing, the results show that environmental concern does not have a significant impact on minimalism ($\beta=-0.016$, $p=0.836 >0.05$), thus hypothesis H4 is rejected.

Hypothesis H6 proposed that environmental concern has a positive impact on consumers' sustainable fashion consumption intention. However, after testing, the results show that environmental concern does not have a positive impact on consumers' sustainable consumption intention ($\beta=0.077$, $p=0.155 >0.05$), thus hypothesis H6 is rejected.

Table 4.3.4. Results of Research Hypothesis Testing in the Model

	Original sample (O)	Sample mean (M)	Standard Deviation (STDEV)	T statistics (O/STDEV)	P-value
SA→ MN	0.263	0.262	0.090	2.917	0.004
GW→MN	0.148	0.154	0.072	2.071	0.038
LA→MN	0.072	0.069	0.073	0.986	0.324
EC→ MN	-0.016	-0.009	0.077	0.206	0.836
PP → MN	0.130	0.132	0.062	2.099	0.036
EC→ FI	0.077	0.077	0.054	1.422	0.155

PP → FI	0.404	0.406	0.055	7.362	0.000
MN→FI	0.191	0.187	0.067	2.840	0.005

Source: Data processed using SmartPLS 4

The analysis results indicate that the square root of the AVE value for each construct is higher than the correlation coefficients with other latent variables, demonstrating that the constructs have achieved discriminant validity and ensuring their independence and clarity within the research model.

Table 4.3.5. Summary of Hypothesis Testing Results

	Results	
	Sig	Conclude
H1: Simple aesthetics has a positive influence on minimalism.	0.004	Supported
H2: Greenwashing perception has a positive influence on the tendency to pursue minimalism.	0.038	Supported
H3: Sustainable label awareness has a positive influence on minimalism.	0.324	Rejected
H4: Environmental concern has a positive impact on minimalism.	0.836	Rejected
H5: Price perception has a positive influence on minimalism.	0.036	Supported
H6: Environmental concern has a positive impact on consumers' sustainable fashion consumption intention.	0.155	Rejected

H7: Price perception has a positive influence on sustainable fashion consumption intention.	0.000	Supported
H8: Minimalism has a positive impact on consumers' sustainable fashion consumption intention.	0.005	Supported

Source: Data processed using SmartPLS 4

4.4. Mediation Analysis

The mediating role of variables in the relationships with the dependent variables was assessed using the Bootstrap 10000 method (Hair & Alamer, 2022). The results indicate that MN serves as a significant mediator in the relationship between SA and FI. However, MN does not function as a significant mediator in the relationships between EC and FI, PL and FI, PP and FI, and GW and FI.

Table 4.4. Results of hypothesis testing in the model

	Original sample (O)	P-value	Result
EC → MN → FI	-0.003	0.842	Rejected
LA → MN → FI	0.014	0.411	Rejected
SA → MN → FI	0.050	0.008	Supported
PP → MN → FI	0.025	0.121	Rejected
GW → MN → FI	0.028	0.073	Rejected

Source: Data processed using SmartPLS 4

EC → MN → FI (Indirect effect coefficient = -0.003, $p = 0.842$): The results indicate that the mediating role of MN in the relationship between EC and FI is not statistically

significant, with $p = 0.842 (>0.05)$. This shows that MN does not act as a mediator between EC and FI, meaning MN is not the intermediary factor through which EC influences FI. Furthermore, EC does not significantly impact MN ($p = 0.836$) and also does not directly affect FI ($p = 0.155$). In other words, environmental concern does not lead to sustainable fashion consumption intention through a minimalist lifestyle. It is possible that EC affects FI through a different mechanism, or it is not a significant factor in this context.

LA $\rightarrow$ MN $\rightarrow$ FI (Indirect effect coefficient = 0.014, $p = 0.411$): The results show that the mediating role of MN in the relationship between PL and FI is not statistically significant, with $p = 0.411 (>0.05)$. This indicates that MN does not act as a mediator between PL and FI, meaning MN is not the intermediary factor through which PL influences FI. This result is consistent with the direct effect of PL on MN being rejected, showing that PL does not have a significant influence on MN and therefore cannot indirectly impact FI through MN. This demonstrates that the sustainable label awareness has a direct impact on the intention to sustainable fashion consumption intention without going through mediating factors.

SA $\rightarrow$ MN $\rightarrow$ FI (Indirect effect coefficient = 0.050, $p = 0.008$): The results show that the relationship between SA and FI is mediated by MN, with an indirect effect coefficient of 0.050 and $p = 0.008 (< 0.05)$. Therefore, MN plays a mediating role in the relationship between SA and FI, meaning that the perception of simple aesthetics not only directly influences the intention to sustainable fashion consumption intention but also does so through minimalism.

PP $\rightarrow$ MN $\rightarrow$ FI (Indirect effect coefficient = 0.025, $p = 0.121$): Although price perception has a direct influence on both minimalism ($p = 0.036$) and sustainable fashion consumption intention ($p = 0.000$), the indirect effect through MN is not statistically significant ($p = 0.121 > 0.05$). This indicates that MN does not act as a mediator in the relationship between PP and FI. In other words, price perception primarily impacts consumption intention through a direct path, not through minimalism.

GW $\rightarrow$ MN $\rightarrow$ FI (Indirect effect coefficient = 0.028, $p = 0.073$): The greenwashing perception has a positive influence on the minimalism ($p = 0.038$), but the effect of GW on

consumption intention through MN is not statistically significant ($p = 0.073 > 0.05$). This shows that MN is not a mediating factor between GW and FI. Although consumers recognize greenwashing perception and tend to live more minimally, this change is not yet strong enough to translate into sustainable fashion consumption intention.

4.5. Discussion of Research Results

Discussion of Measurement Model Testing Results

The results of the scale testing indicate that the research variables in the model, including Simple Aesthetics, Greenwashing Perception, Sustainable Label Awareness, Environmental Concern, Price Perception, Minimalism, and Sustainable Fashion Consumption Intention, achieved the necessary reliability for conducting the study. Furthermore, these variables were confirmed to ensure convergent and discriminant validity, affirming the integrity and accuracy of the measurement model. Therefore, the research model is considered reliable and suitable for further in-depth analyses in subsequent stages.

Discussion of Relationship Testing Results in the Model

Based on the integrated theoretical framework of TPB and SOR proposed, the study tested the impact of factors such as Simple Aesthetics, Greenwashing Perception, Sustainable Label Awareness, Price Perception, and Environmental Concern on Minimalism and Sustainable Fashion Consumption Intention among consumers. The analysis results clarified the mediating role of Minimalism in transforming stimulus factors into sustainable consumption behavior, while also evaluating the direct influence of certain factors, such as Sustainable Label Awareness and Environmental Concern, on Sustainable Fashion Consumption Intention. These findings not only reinforce the applicability of the model in the context of sustainable fashion consumption but also provide a scientific basis for proposing appropriate management strategies.

Hypothesis H1 proposed that Simple Aesthetics positively influences Minimalism. The obtained significance level ($\beta=0.263$, $p=0.004 < 0.05$) supports Hypothesis H1. This finding aligns with the study by Jain, Joy, and Sharma, (2024), which indicated that simple

aesthetics positively affects minimalism with a coefficient of $\beta=0.553$. However, the degree of influence in this study is lower than that in Jain, Joy, and Sharma (2024). This difference may stem from the research context in Ho Chi Minh City, where cultural factors, urban lifestyles, and consumption habits may reduce the impact of minimalist aesthetics compared to studies in Western contexts. Additionally, studies by Martin-Woodhead and Waight (2023) and Wilson, and Bellezza (2024) also confirm that simple aesthetics is a core characteristic of minimalism, further supporting the results of this study. However, the lower β value may suggest that minimalist aesthetics in Ho Chi Minh City plays a supplementary rather than a decisive role in the minimalist trend.

Hypothesis H2 proposed that Greenwashing Perception positively influences the pursuit of Minimalism. The obtained significance level ($\beta=0.148$, $p=0.038 < 0.05$) supports Hypothesis H2. This finding is consistent with psychological reactance theory (Brehm, 1966), where consumers react to dishonest marketing campaigns by shifting toward a minimalist lifestyle. Compared to studies by Kasser (2017) and Wilson, and Bellezza (2024), this result reinforces the view that minimalism is a reactive consumption response to materialism and inauthentic marketing strategies. However, the relatively low influence level ($\beta=0.148$) suggests that greenwashing perception is only one of many factors promoting minimalism in Ho Chi Minh City. This difference may be due to varying levels of sensitivity to greenwashing perception among consumers or the influence of other cultural and economic factors on consumption behavior.

Hypothesis H3 proposed that Sustainable Label Awareness positively influences Minimalism. The obtained significance level ($\beta=0.072$, $p=0.324 > 0.05$) rejects Hypothesis H3, indicating that sustainable label awareness does not have a notable impact on minimalism in the situation of Ho Chi Minh City. This result contradicts the research by Yadav and Kar (2024), which demonstrated that sustainable label awareness positively influences minimalism. This difference may be explained by the level of awareness and prevalence of sustainable labels in Ho Chi Minh City, where certifications such as GOTS may not be widely recognized or valued in consumption decisions. Additionally, a lack of

transparency or skepticism about the authenticity of sustainable labels in the Vietnamese market may reduce the impact of this factor on the minimalist trend.

Hypothesis H4 proposed that Environmental Concern positively influences Minimalism. The obtained significance level ($\beta = -0.016$, $p = 0.836 > 0.05$) rejects Hypothesis H4, indicating that environmental concern shows no notable influence on minimalism in this study. This result contradicts previous studies such as Blackburn, Leviston, and Walker (2025) and Jain, Joy, and Sharma (2024), which affirmed environmental concern as a key driver of minimalist lifestyles. This difference may stem from cultural characteristics and the level of environmental awareness in Ho Chi Minh City. Consumers here may prioritize pragmatic factors such as cost or aesthetics over environmental values when adopting a minimalist lifestyle. Additionally, the lack of sustainable product options or information about environmental impacts may diminish the role of environmental concern in shaping minimalist trends.

Hypothesis H5 proposed that Price Perception positively influences Minimalism. The obtained significance level ($\beta = 0.130$, $p = 0.036 < 0.05$) supports Hypothesis H5. This finding aligns with studies by Wenny et al. (2021) and Blackburn, Leviston, and Walker (2025), where consumers with high price perception often prioritize quality, sustainable products that align with the “less but better” philosophy of minimalism. However, the relatively low influence level ($\beta = 0.130$) suggests that price perception is only a supplementary factor within the setting of Ho Chi Minh City, where other factors such as aesthetics or consumption habits may play a larger role.

Hypothesis H6 proposed that Environmental Concern positively influences Sustainable Consumption Intention. The obtained significance level ($\beta = 0.077$, $p = 0.155 > 0.05$) rejects Hypothesis H6, indicating that environmental concern does not have a significant influence on sustainable fashion consumption intention in the research context. This result contradicts previous studies such as Yue, Li, Liu, Jin, and Bao (2024) and Hartmann and Apaolaza-Ibañez (2012), which affirmed environmental concern as a key predictor of sustainable fashion consumption intention. This difference may be due to consumers in Ho Chi Minh City not fully connecting environmental concern with

sustainable fashion consumption intention, or due to barriers such as cost, product availability, or lack of information about sustainable options.

Hypothesis H7 proposed that Price Perception positively influences Sustainable Consumption Intention. The obtained significance level ($\beta=0.404$, $p=0.000 < 0.05$) supports Hypothesis H7. This finding is consistent with studies by Okur, Saricam, Iri, and Sari (2023) and Nguyen et al. (2025), where consumers with high price perception tend to purchase sustainable products if they consider the price to be reasonable relative to the benefits. The high β coefficient (0.404) indicates that price perception is a significant factor in the context of Ho Chi Minh City, where consumers tend to carefully weigh costs against the long-term value of products.

Hypothesis H8 proposed that Minimalism positively influences Sustainable Fashion Consumption Intention. The obtained significance level ($\beta=0.191$, $p=0.005 < 0.05$) supports Hypothesis H8. This result aligns with studies by Deveci & Yildiz (2025) and Laaksonen (2024), where minimalism promotes selective consumption behavior prioritizing quality and durability, thus supporting sustainable choices. The moderate influence level ($\beta=0.191$) suggests that minimalism plays an important but not exclusive role in driving sustainable fashion consumption intentions in Ho Chi Minh City. Other factors, such as price perception or information about sustainable products, may also contribute significantly.

4.6. Summary

This chapter presented the results of survey outcomes and the corresponding analysis from a sample of young consumers in the fashion industry. Descriptive statistics presented a summary of participants' demographic information, while the scale tests ensured the reliability and discriminant validity of the research variables. The structural model analysis indicated different levels of influence in the relationships between minimalism and factors related to sustainable fashion consumption intentions. Among the eight proposed hypotheses, five were supported and three were rejected. These results provide a quantitative basis for further analyzing theoretical and practical implications, and form the basis for addressing the study's limitations and outlining future research avenues in the next chapter.

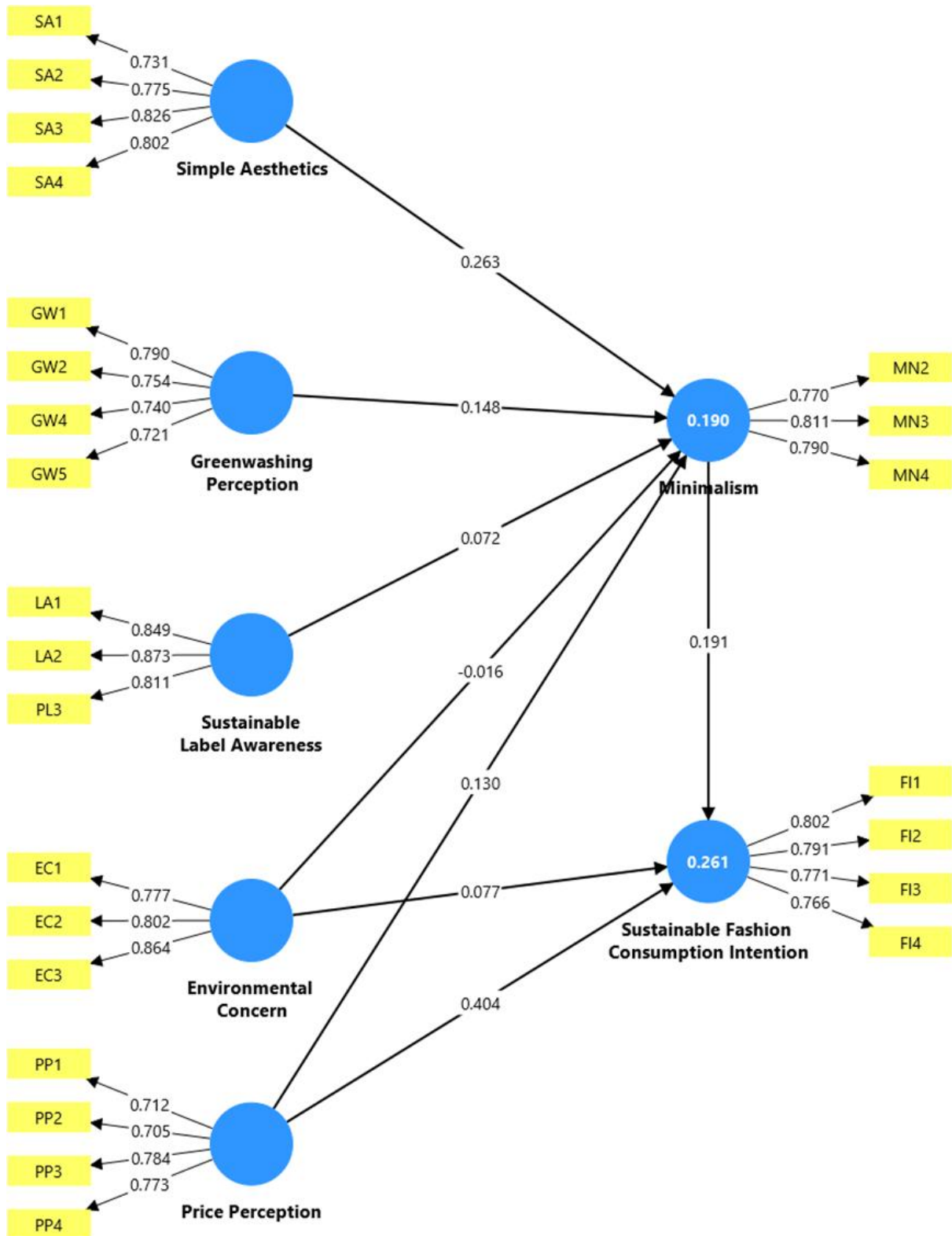


Figure 5. Results of the Research Model Analysis

Source: Data processed using SmartPLS 4

CHAPTER 5: CONCLUSION AND IMPLICATIONS

5.1. Conclusion

The main objective of the study was to examine the impact of factors including environmental concern (EC), price perception (PP), sustainable label awareness (LA), simple aesthetics (SA), greenwashing perception (GW), and minimalism (MN) on sustainable fashion consumption intention (FI). This is a topic of urgent significance in the current context, as environmental issues become increasingly severe and the trend of environmentally responsible consumption gradually becomes a standard in modern society. The inclusion of minimalism in the research model is a novel point, reflecting a changing consumption trend: a shift from mass, excessive consumption to selective consumption that focuses more on core values.

The analysis results from 354 valid responses from consumers in Ho Chi Minh City show that the scales in the model have high reliability (Cronbach's Alpha > 0.7) and ensure both convergent and discriminant validity. The analysis results indicated that price perception is the factor with a medium and the strongest impact on sustainable consumption behavior, with an effect size (f^2) of 0.205 and a standardized path coefficient of 0.404. This confirms the central role of price in consumers' sustainable product purchasing decisions. In the context of the Vietnamese market, price remains a key factor that strongly influences product choice, especially for the general customer segment. Consumers often consider economic benefits when choosing environmentally friendly products, the price difference between solid and mainstream products is one of the biggest barriers to promoting solid consumption across the board.

Furthermore, minimalism has a positive and statistically significant impact on sustainable consumption behavior ($\beta = 0.191$, $p = 0.005$), although the effect size of this factor is not yet very large ($f^2 = 0.044$). While not yet a major influence, this result reflects a shift in the consciousness of a group of Vietnamese consumers, particularly those who are beginning to pay more attention to reducing excess consumption, prioritizing simplicity,

and focusing on the quality and long-term value of products. This can be seen as a positive signal, indicating that the trend of minimalism is gradually being internalized in consumption behavior. This result suggests that minimalism is not just a personal lifestyle but also an ethical foundation and consumption philosophy capable of promoting the development of sustainable consumption in modern society.

Factors such as environmental concern (EC), greenwashing perception (GW), and sustainable label awareness (LA), although having a positive relationship, did not have a significant impact on sustainable consumption behavior. This result indicates that although consumers may be aware of environmental issues, understand sustainable labels, or recognize greenwashing, these factors are not yet strong enough to translate into actual sustainable consumption behavior. Nevertheless, the minimalist lifestyle, characterized by restraint and deep self-awareness, is playing a role in naturally and more sustainably fostering sustainability consciousness compared to conventional media impacts.

The research results have contributed to clarifying the overall picture of the key determinants of sustainable consumption behavior in Vietnam. Among them, price is a key factor, minimalism is a potential factor, while other factors have not yet had a significant impact. These findings provide valuable empirical evidence for both academic research and practical applications in business administration and policymaking.

5.2. Research implications

5.2.1. Theoretical implications

Theoretically, this study has expanded the theoretical basis of sustainable consumption behavior by adding minimalism as a new explanatory factor for responsible consumption. Unlike previous studies that primarily focused on environmental awareness or social norms, the results show that a minimalist lifestyle has a positive and direct impact on sustainable consumption behavior. The study thereby transforms minimalism from a cultural phenomenon into a measurable social variable, clarifying the role of life values and personal philosophy in forming green consumer intentions, and filling a theoretical gap in current consumer behavior models.

The study has made a significant contribution to expanding and deepening the theoretical framework of green consumption behavior by integrating two foundational models: the Theory of Planned Behavior (TPB) and the Stimulus-Organism-Response (SOR). This combination allows for a more comprehensive explanation of the process of forming sustainable consumption intention, where external stimuli (such as perceptions of price, sustainable labels, or personal values) affect the internal psychological state (organism), manifested through a minimalist lifestyle, which in turn leads to a behavioral response (intention to consume sustainable fashion). This approach helps overcome the limitations of traditional models, which mainly focus on the linear relationship between cognition and behavior without deeply considering the mediating psychological factors and life values of consumers.

The successful testing of the mediating role of minimalism is a significant theoretical contribution, as it confirms the indirect impact mechanism between external stimuli and sustainable consumption behavior. The study has elevated minimalism from a social trend to a psychological-behavioral construct that can be measured and empirically tested, expanding the theoretical framework of green consumption behavior. In doing so, this work positions minimalism as a new structural variable, creating a foundation for future research on lifestyle and sustainable consumption. The theoretical contribution of this study lies not only in clarifying the impact of minimalism on sustainable consumption but also in shaping a new mindset for future research, where humans are seen as the center of sustainable development, and consumption behavior is viewed as a concrete expression of life values, ethical philosophy, along with a sense of social responsibility and environmental protection.

5.2.2. Practical implications

From a practical standpoint, this study offers important implications for promoting sustainable consumption behavior in the context of Vietnam's gradual transition to a green economy and sustainable development. Currently, the country faces many alarming environmental problems such as air pollution, increasing plastic waste, over-exploitation of resources, and immense pressure on urban waste treatment systems. In this context,

fostering and expanding sustainable consumption behavior is particularly crucial for achieving national sustainable development goals.

The research results have shown that the price factor plays a decisive role in consumers' sustainable consumption behavior. This is also the main barrier preventing many people from choosing environmentally friendly products. The reality in Vietnam shows that the majority of consumers are still price-sensitive, especially those in the middle and low-income groups. The study also shows that awareness of sustainable labels and greenwashing currently does not have a significant impact on actual behavior. This reflects limitations in the certification and control systems for greenwashing in Vietnam. When consumers do not truly trust labels, information about green products is easily overlooked, leading to a large gap between awareness and behavior.

Particularly when related to the reality in TP. HCM, the research findings are even more highly meaningful. The city is the largest economic and commercial center in the country, with a dense population, numerous production and service activities, and it is also the locality facing the greatest environmental pressure. Concurrently, the rapid growth of the middle class, with good purchasing power and high access to information, has created favorable conditions for promoting sustainable consumption models.

Clarifying the relationship between minimalism and sustainable consumption behavior not only contributes to expanding the understanding of modern consumer behavior but also provides concrete suggestions for businesses, government agencies, social organizations, and consumers themselves in promoting a responsible and environmentally friendly consumption model. It can be seen that the minimalist lifestyle is increasingly influencing consumption behavior, opening up opportunities for product development and marketing strategies based on the "less but better" value proposition. Businesses can focus on creating products with simple designs, high durability, and environmental friendliness, and communicate transparently about their sustainability.

Regulatory agencies can use these results to develop community communication programs, integrate education on life values and responsible consumption into sustainable development policies, encourage conscious consumption behavior, strengthen trust in

sustainable certifications, and issue specific support policies for green businesses. This is an important step in shaping the market towards greater sustainability while reducing pressure on the urban environment. For consumers, adopting a minimalist lifestyle not only helps reduce spending and material stress but also encourages selective consumption, reduces waste, and leads to a more balanced and meaningful life. Thus, the practical significance of the study is demonstrated by translating the philosophy of minimalism into concrete actions, contributing to promoting a shift in consumer awareness and behavior towards being more responsible, humane, and sustainable.

In summary, the research results not only have theoretical value but also create a solid practical basis for businesses, managers, and consumers to participate in the process of building a sustainable consumption ecosystem. In large cities like TP. HCM, which possess all the necessary economic, social, and living standard conditions, these implications are highly applicable and can act as an important lever to promote the transition to green and responsible consumption.

5.3. Limitations and Future Research

Although this study has made significant contributions to clarifying the role of minimalism in shaping sustainable fashion consumption intentions TP. HCM, several limitations remain. These limitations highlight opportunities for future research to enhance the comprehensiveness and reliability of the findings.

First, the sample size of this study may not be large enough to fully represent the diversity of consumers in TP. HCM. Although a probability random sampling method was employed, the use of an online survey via Google Forms may have introduced bias, as certain demographic groups who do not use the internet or are unfamiliar with online surveys might have been excluded. Future studies should increase the sample size and adopt more diverse data collection methods, such as in-person interviews or on-site surveys, to improve representativeness and minimize sampling bias.

Second, the observed variables used in this study, including perceptions of greenwashing, awareness of sustainable labeling, and environmental concern, were

constructed on solid theoretical foundations but may not fully capture all factors influencing minimalism and sustainable fashion consumption intentions in TP. HCM. Factors such as urban cultural influence, individual psychological motivations, or specific consumption trends of the city were not thoroughly examined. Future research should examine these additional elements and consider the contribution of social media or environmental education in shaping green consumption behavior in local contexts.

Third, while this study acknowledged the existence of the awareness and action gap, the detailed mechanisms underlying this gap were not deeply analyzed. Factors hindering the translation of awareness into actual behavior, such as cost, consumption habits, or lack of information about sustainable products, were not examined in depth. Future studies should employ qualitative methods or advanced analytical models to identify and address these barriers, thereby proposing practical solutions to bridge this gap in TP. HCM.

Fourth, the data were gathered over a short period from September 25, 2025 to October 9, 2025, which may not capture temporal variations in consumer perceptions and behaviors in TP. HCM. Sustainable consumption trends and minimalism can be influenced by economic and social fluctuations within the city. Therefore, future studies should apply longitudinal research designs to monitor behavioral changes over time, providing insights into the durability and long-term impacts of these trends in Ho Chi Minh City.

Finally, to enhance practical applicability, future research should focus on proposing specific strategies for businesses and local authorities in Ho Chi Minh City. These may include community education programs on sustainable consumption, incentives for green fashion enterprises, or communication campaigns aimed at raising awareness about minimalist lifestyles and environmental impacts. Such directions would not only address current limitations but also contribute to fostering a more sustainable fashion ecosystem in Ho Chi Minh City.

REFERENCES

- A. Sandlin, J., & Wallin, J. J. (2021a). Decluttering the Pandemic: Marie Kondo, Minimalism, and the “Joy” of Waste. *Cultural Studies ↔ Critical Methodologies*, 22(1), 153270862110497. <https://doi.org/10.1177/15327086211049703>
- A. Sandlin, J., & Wallin, J. J. (2021b). Decluttering the Pandemic: Marie Kondo, Minimalism, and the “Joy” of Waste. *Cultural Studies ↔ Critical Methodologies*, 22(1), 153270862110497. <https://doi.org/10.1177/15327086211049703>
- Abbas, S., Chiang Hsieh, L. H., Techato, K., & Taweekun, J. (2020). Sustainable production using a resource-energy-water nexus for the Pakistani textile industry. *Journal of Cleaner Production*, 271, 122633. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jclepro.2020.122633>
- Adamkiewicz, J., Kochanska, E., Adamkiewicz, I., & Łukasik, R. M. (2022). Greenwashing and Sustainable Fashion Industry. *Current Opinion in Green and Sustainable Chemistry*, 38(100710). <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.cogsc.2022.100710>
- Ajzen, I. (1991). The theory of planned behavior. *Organizational Behavior and Human Decision Processes*, 50(2), 179-211. [https://doi.org/10.1016/0749-5978\(91\)90020-T](https://doi.org/10.1016/0749-5978(91)90020-T)
- Ajzen, I. (2002). Perceived behavioral control, self-efficacy, locus of control, and the theory of planned behavior. *Journal of Applied Social Psychology*, 32(4), 665-683. <https://doi.org/10.1111/j.1559-1816.2002.tb00236.x>
- Alizadeh, L., Liscio, M. C., & Sospiro, P. (2024). The Phenomenon of Greenwashing in the Fashion industry: a Conceptual Framework. *Sustainable Chemistry and Pharmacy*, 37(101416), 101416. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.scp.2023.101416>
- Balderjahn, I., Seegebarth, B., & Lee, M. S. W. (2020). Less is more! The rationale behind the decision-making style of voluntary simplifiers. *Journal of Cleaner Production*, 124802. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jclepro.2020.124802>
- Bezençon, V., & Etemad-Sajadi, R. (2015). The effect of a sustainable label portfolio on

- consumer perception of ethicality and retail patronage. *International Journal of Retail & Distribution Management*, 43(4/5), 314-328.
<https://doi.org/10.1108/ijrdm-03-2014-0035>
- Blackburn, R., Leviston, Z., & Walker, I. (2025). The environmental impact and wellbeing benefits of minimalism. *Journal of Environmental Psychology*, 102618.
<https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jenvp.2025.102618>
- Brehm, J. (1966). A theory of psychological reactance. Retrieved from psycnet.apa.org website: <https://psycnet.apa.org/record/1967-08061-000>
- Brehm, S. S., & Brehm, J. W. (1981). *Psychological reactance : A theory of freedom and control*. New York: Academic Press.
- Cho, M., Ko, E., & Borenstein, B. E. (2024). The interaction effect of fashion retailer categories on sustainable labels: the role of perceived benefits, ambiguity, trust, and purchase intention. *International Journal of Advertising*, 43(6), 1-23.
<https://doi.org/10.1080/02650487.2024.2306763>
- Cohen, J., Cohen, P., West, S. G., & Aiken, L. S. (2013). *Applied Multiple Regression/Correlation Analysis for the Behavioral Sciences*. Routledge.
<https://doi.org/10.4324/9780203774441>
- D'Souza, C., Gilmore, A. J., Hartmann, P., Apaolaza Ibáñez, V., & Sullivan-Mort, G. (2014). Male eco-fashion: a market reality. *International Journal of Consumer Studies*, 39(1), 35-42. <https://doi.org/10.1111/ijcs.12148>
- Dangelico, R. M., Alvino, L., & Fraccascia, L. (2022). Investigating the Antecedents of Consumer Behavioral Intention for Sustainable Fashion products: Evidence from a Large Survey of Italian Consumers. *Technological Forecasting and Social Change*, 185(0040-1625), 122010. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.techfore.2022.122010>
- Dunlap, R. E., & Jones, R. E. (2002, October 10). Environmental Concern: Conceptual and Measurement Issues. Retrieved from ResearchGate website:
https://www.researchgate.net/publication/285810112_Environmental_Concern_Conceptual_and_Measurement_Issues

ECBD. (2023). eCommerce Data & Analytics Based on Billions of Transactions.

Retrieved from Ecdb.com website: <https://ecdb.com/resources/sample-data/market/vn/fashion>

Ertekin, Z. O., & Atik, D. (2020). Institutional Constituents of Change for a Sustainable Fashion System. *Journal of Macromarketing*, 40(3), 362-379.

<https://doi.org/10.1177/0276146720932274>

Font, X., Andreu, L., Mattila, A. S., & Aldas-Manzano, J. (2025). Sustainability information overload: Its effect on customers' greenwashing perceptions, perceived value, and behavioral intentions. *Journal of Hospitality and Tourism Management*, 62, 196-204. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jhtm.2025.01.013>

Fransson, N., & Garling, T. (1999). Environmental concern: Conceptual definitions, Measurement methods, and Research Findings. *Journal of Environmental Psychology*, 19(4), 369-382. <https://doi.org/10.1006/jevp.1999.0141>

Ghaffar, A., & Islam, T. (2023). Factors leading to sustainable consumption behavior: an empirical investigation among millennial consumers. *Kybernetes*, 53(8). <https://doi.org/10.1108/k-12-2022-1675>

Hair, J. F., Howard, M. C., & Nitzl, C. (2019). Assessing measurement model quality in PLS-SEM using confirmatory composite analysis. *Journal of Business Research*, 109(1), 101-110. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jbusres.2019.11.069>

Hair, J. F., Hult, G. T. M., Ringle, C. M., Sarstedt, M., Danks, N. P., & Ray, S. (2021). Partial Least Squares Structural Equation Modeling (PLS-SEM) Using R. In *Classroom Companion: Business*. Springer International Publishing. <https://doi.org/10.1007/978-3-030-80519-7>

Haller, K., Wallace, M., Cheung, J., & Gupta, S. (2022, January 13). 2022 consumer study: Consumers want it all. Retrieved from IBM website: <https://www.ibm.com/thought-leadership/institute-business-value/en-us/report/2022-consumer-study>

Hartmann, P., & Apaolaza-Ibañez, V. (2012). Consumer Attitude and Purchase Intention

- toward Green Energy brands: the Roles of Psychological Benefits and Environmental Concern. *Journal of Business Research*, 65(9), 1254-1263.
<https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jbusres.2011.11.001>
- Henseler, J., Ringle, C. M., & Sarstedt, M. (2015). A new criterion for assessing discriminant validity in variance-based structural equation modeling. *Journal of the Academy of Marketing Science*, 43(1), 115-135. Retrieved from
<https://link.springer.com/article/10.1007/s11747-014-0403-8>
- Herziger, A., Berkessel, J. B., & Steinnes, K. K. (2020). Wean off green: On the (in)effectiveness of biospheric appeals for consumption curtailment. *Journal of Environmental Psychology*, 69, 101415.
<https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jenvp.2020.101415>
- Hewei, T., & Youngsook, L. (2021). Factors Affecting Continuous Purchase Intention of Fashion Products on Social E-commerce: SOR Model and the Mediating Effect. *Entertainment Computing*, 41(100474).
<https://doi.org/10.1016/j.entcom.2021.100474>
- Hride, F. T., Ferdousi, F., & Jasimuddin, S. M. (2021). Linking perceived price fairness, customer satisfaction, trust, and loyalty: A structural equation modeling of Facebook-based e-commerce in Bangladesh. *Global Business and Organizational Excellence*. <https://doi.org/10.1002/joe.22146>
- Jain, V. K., Joy, V., & Sharma, P. (2024). Minimalistic consumption practices and well-being among generation Z: exploring mediating role of satisfaction and happiness. *Environment, Development and Sustainability*. <https://doi.org/10.1007/s10668-024-05722-y>
- Jimenez-Fernandez, A., Aramendía-Muneta, M. E., & Alzate, M. (2023). Consumers' Awareness and Attitudes in Circular Fashion. *Cleaner and Responsible Consumption*, 11(11), 100144-100144. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.clrc.2023.100144>
- Kalyanaram, G., Saini, G. K., Mony, S., & Jayasankaran, N. (2022). Behavioral response to online pricing: empirical and managerial insights. *Journal of Indian Business*

Research, ahead-of-print(ahead-of-print). <https://doi.org/10.1108/jibr-07-2021-0281>

- Kamal, M., & Nasir, O. (2022). Minimalism in architecture: a basis for resource conservation and sustainable development. *Facta Universitatis - Series: Architecture and Civil Engineering*, 20(3), 277-300.
<https://doi.org/10.2298/fuace221105021k>
- Kaner, G. (2021). Greenwashing: How Difficult It Is to Be Transparent to the Consumer—H&M Case Study. *Green Marketing in Emerging Markets*, 203-226.
https://doi.org/10.1007/978-3-030-74065-8_9
- Kang, J., Martinez, C. M. J., & Johnson, C. (2021). Minimalism as a sustainable lifestyle: Its behavioral representations and contributions to emotional well-being. *Sustainable Production and Consumption*, 27(27), 802-813.
<https://doi.org/10.1016/j.spc.2021.02.001>
- Khurana, K., & Ricchetti, M. (2016). Two decades of sustainable supply chain management in the fashion business, an appraisal. *Journal of Fashion Marketing and Management: An International Journal*, 20(1), 89-104.
- Kotler, P., & Armstrong, G. (2018). *Principles of marketing*. Singapore: Pearson/Prentice-Hall.
- Kumalasari, R., & Priharsari, D. (2023). Investigating the Role of SNS Design on Covid-19 Information Avoidance: The Perspectives of the Stimulus-Organism-Response Theory. *Telematics and Informatics Reports*, 11, 100083.
<https://doi.org/10.1016/j.teler.2023.100083>
- Laaksonen, E. (2024). Minimalism in consumption - exploring the connection between minimalism and sustainable fashion consumption. Retrieved from Aalto.fi website: <https://aaltodoc.aalto.fi/items/491ace03-9afc-4cb8-bdda-727e308dc661>
- Lee, H., Ko, E., & Lee, S. (2023). The effect of luxury brands' sustainable fashion marketing types on authenticity, brand attitude, and purchase intention. *Journal of Global Scholars of Marketing Science*, 33(4), 497-512.

- Maduku, D. K. (2024). How environmental concerns influence consumers' anticipated emotions towards sustainable consumption: The moderating role of regulatory focus. *Journal of Retailing and Consumer Services*, 76(103593), 103593. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jretconser.2023.103593>
- Majer, J. M., Henscher, H. A., Reuber, P., Fischer-Kreer, D., & Fischer, D. (2022). The effects of visual sustainability labels on consumer perception and behavior: A systematic review of the empirical literature. *Sustainable Production and Consumption*, 33(1). <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.spc.2022.06.012>
- Martin-Woodhead, A. (2021). Limited, considered and sustainable consumption: The (non)consumption practices of UK minimalists. *Journal of Consumer Culture*, 22(4), 146954052110396. <https://doi.org/10.1177/14695405211039608>
- Martin-Woodhead, A., & Waight, E. (2023). Less is more: the sustainable potential of minimalist families. *Edward Elgar Publishing EBooks*, 190-203. <https://doi.org/10.4337/9781802202021.00019>
- Mehrabian, A., & Russell, J. A. (1974). *An approach to environmental psychology*. Cambridge: M.I.T. Press.
- Naman Sreen, Mehrotra, A., Rsha Alghafes, & Agarwal, V. (2024). Interplay between minimalism, moral identity, and ethically minded consumer behavior in retail context: Cross-cultural investigation of Indian and American consumers. *Journal of Retailing and Consumer Services*, 84, 104191-104191. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jretconser.2024.104191>
- Nguyen, K. M., Thi, L., Ngo, T. T., Thi, T., Dinh, P., Pham, H., & Nguyen, N. T. (2025). The Impact of 7Ps Green Marketing Mix on Customer Commitment and Willingness to Pay a Premium Price: Evidence from Vietnam. *Journal of Promotion Management*, 1-42. <https://doi.org/10.1080/10496491.2025.2484712>
- Nyilasy, G., Gangadharbatla, H., & Paladino, A. (2014). Perceived Greenwashing: The Interactive Effects of Green Advertising and Corporate Environmental Performance on Consumer Reactions. *Journal of Business Ethics*, 125(4), 693-707.

<https://doi.org/10.1007/s10551-013-1944-3>

- Okur, N., Saricam, C., Iri, A. R., & Sari, I. (2023). Analyzing the impact of Covid-19 on sustainable fashion consumption with a model based on consumer value perceptions. *Journal of Fashion Marketing and Management: An International Journal*, 27(5), 1-25. <https://doi.org/10.1108/jfmm-10-2021-0272>
- Pangarkar, A., Shukla, P., & Taylor, C. R. “Ray”. (2021a). Minimalism in consumption: A typology and brand engagement strategies. *Journal of Business Research*, 127(1), 167-178. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jbusres.2021.01.033>
- Pangarkar, A., Shukla, P., & Taylor, C. R. “Ray”. (2021b). Minimalism in consumption: A typology and brand engagement strategies. *Journal of Business Research*, 127(1), 167-178. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jbusres.2021.01.033>
- Park, H. J., & Lin, L. M. (2020). Exploring Attitude-behavior Gap in Sustainable consumption: Comparison of Recycled and Upcycled Fashion Products. *Journal of Business Research*, 117(2), 623-628. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jbusres.2018.08.025>
- Paudel, P. (2024). Exploring the impact of greenwashing and sustainability awareness on the purchase decisions of Generation X and Generation Y consumers in the fashion industry. *Lutpub.lut.fi*. <https://lutpub.lut.fi/handle/10024/168351>
- Prihatini, W., & Gumilang, D. A. (2021). The Effect of Price Perception, Brand Image and Personal Selling on the Repurchase Intention of Consumers B to B of Indonesian General Fishery Companies with Customer Satisfaction as Intervening Variables. *European Journal of Business and Management Research*, 6(2), 91-95. <https://doi.org/10.24018/ejbmr.2021.6.2.756>
- Rausch, T. M., & Kopplin, C. S. (2021). Bridge the gap: Consumers’ Purchase Intention and Behavior regarding Sustainable Clothing. *Journal of Cleaner Production*, 278(123882). <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jclepro.2020.123882>
- Rume, T., & Islam, S. M. D.-U. (2020). Environmental Effects of COVID-19 Pandemic and Potential Strategies of Sustainability. *Heliyon*, 6(9). <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.heliyon.2020.e04965>

- Sarmadi, M., Rahimi, S., Evensen, D., & Kazemi Moghaddam, V. (2021). Interaction between meteorological parameters and COVID-19: an ecological study on 406 authorities of the UK. *Environmental Science and Pollution Research*, 28(47), 67082-67097. <https://doi.org/10.1007/s11356-021-15279-2>
- Schwartz, S. H. (1977). Normative Influences on Altruism. *Advances in Experimental Social Psychology*, 10, 221-279. [https://doi.org/10.1016/s0065-2601\(08\)60358-5](https://doi.org/10.1016/s0065-2601(08)60358-5)
- Şener, T., Bişkin, F., & Dünder, N. (2022). The effects of perceived value, environmental concern and attitude on recycled fashion consumption. *Journal of Fashion Marketing and Management: An International Journal*, 27(4), 1-17. <https://doi.org/10.1108/jfmm-01-2021-0003>
- Shafqat, T., Ishaq, M. I., & Ahmed, A. (2023). Fashion consumption using minimalism: Exploring the relationship of consumer well-being and social connectedness. *Journal of Retailing and Consumer Services*, 71(71), 103215. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jretconser.2022.103215>
- Stern, P. C., & Dietz, T. (1994). The Value Basis of Environmental Concern. *Journal of Social Issues*, 50(3), 65-84. <https://doi.org/10.1111/j.1540-4560.1994.tb02420.x>
- Streukens, S., & Leroi-Werelds, S. (2016). Bootstrapping and PLS-SEM: A step-by-step guide to get more out of your bootstrap results. *European Management Journal*, 34(6), 618-632. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.emj.2016.06.003>
- Sweeney, J. C., & Soutar, G. N. (2001). Consumer Perceived value: the Development of a Multiple Item Scale. *Journal of Retailing*, 77(2), 203-220. [https://doi.org/10.1016/S0022-4359\(01\)00041-0](https://doi.org/10.1016/S0022-4359(01)00041-0)
- Testa, F., Iovino, R., & Iraldo, F. (2020). The circular economy and consumer behaviour: The mediating role of information seeking in buying circular packaging. *Business Strategy and the Environment*, 29(8). <https://doi.org/10.1002/bse.2587>
- Trí, C. M., & Quynh, T. (2024). Factors affecting sustainable consumption behavior: Roles of pandemics and perceived consumer effectiveness. *Cleaner and Responsible Consumption*, 12, 100158-100158.

<https://doi.org/10.1016/j.clrc.2023.100158>

- Trueman, T., & Management, B. A. of. (2022, September 1). Generation Z members say they want sustainable clothes but buy fast fashion instead, research says. Retrieved from phys.org website: https://phys.org/news/2022-08-members-sustainable-fast-fashion.html#google_vignette
- Unal, U., & Tascioglu, M. (2022). Sustainable, therefore reputable: linking sustainability, reputation, and consumer behaviour. *Marketing Intelligence & Planning*, 40(4). <https://doi.org/10.1108/mip-03-2022-0102>
- UNEP. (2024). Global Waste Management Outlook 2024. Retrieved from UNEP - UN Environment Programme website: <https://www.unep.org/resources/global-waste-management-outlook-2024>
- Vollebregt, M., Mugge, R., Thürridl, C., & van Dolen, W. (2023). Reducing without losing: Reduced consumption and its implications for well-being. *Sustainable Production and Consumption*, 45. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.spc.2023.12.023>
- Walsh, G., Shiu, E., & Hassan, L. M. (2014). Replicating, validating, and reducing the length of the consumer perceived value scale. *Journal of Business Research*, 67(3), 260-267. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jbusres.2013.05.012>
- Williams, A., Hodges, N., & Watchravesringkan, K. (2023). An index is worth a thousand words: Considering consumer perspectives in the development of a sustainability label. *Cleaner and Responsible Consumption*, 11, 100148. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.clrc.2023.100148>
- Wilson, A. V., & Bellezza, S. (2024). Journal of Consumer Research. Retrieved from Doi.org website: <https://doi.org/10.1093/jcr/ucab038>
- Yadav, S. S., & Kar, S. K. (2024). Influence of religious value and minimalism on repurchase intention of sustainable fashion: A combined PLS-SEM and NCA approach. *Journal of Cleaner Production*, 144585-144585. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jclepro.2024.144585>

- YouGov. (2025). Welcome To Zscaler Directory Authentication. Retrieved October 18, 2025, from Yougov.com website: https://today.yougov.com/topics/society/survey-results/daily/2023/04/21/9540a/1?utm_source
- Yue, H., Li, C., Liu, M., Jin, R., & Bao, H. (2024). Validity test of the theory of planned behavior in college students' withdrawal from smartphone dependence. *Current Psychology*, 41. <https://doi.org/10.1007/s12144-020-01068-6>
- Zeithaml, V. A. (1988). Consumer Perceptions of Price, Quality, and Value: A Means-End Model and Synthesis of Evidence. *Journal of Marketing*, 52(3), 2-22. <https://doi.org/10.1177/002224298805200302>
- Zhang, L., Li, D., Cao, C., & Huang, S. (2018). The influence of greenwashing perception on green purchasing intentions: The mediating role of green word-of-mouth and moderating role of green concern. *Journal of Cleaner Production*, 187(1), 740-750. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jclepro.2018.03.201>

APPENDIX

APPENDIX 1: SURVEY FORM

Xin chào quý anh/chị

Chúng em là nhóm sinh viên K49 đến từ Đại học Kinh tế TP. Hồ Chí Minh (UEH), hiện đang thực hiện đề tài nghiên cứu:

“ẢNH HƯỞNG CỦA LỐI SỐNG TỐI GIẢN ĐẾN Ý ĐỊNH TIÊU DÙNG THỜI TRANG BỀN VỮNG: BẢNG CHỨNG TỪ TP. HỒ CHÍ MINH”.

Chúng em rất mong nhận được sự hỗ trợ từ quý anh/chị bằng việc trả lời những câu hỏi trong phiếu khảo sát này. Những câu trả lời của anh/chị sẽ là nguồn dữ liệu quan trọng giúp nhóm nghiên cứu phân tích và đề xuất những giải pháp phù hợp.

Chúng em cam đoan rằng mọi thông tin, số liệu mà quý anh/chị chia sẻ sẽ được thu thập một cách **bảo mật tuyệt đối**, chỉ phục vụ cho mục đích học tập và nghiên cứu.

💡 **Phần quà đặc biệt sẽ xuất hiện sau khi điền form.** Lưu ý: phần quà sẽ được gửi sau khi lọc dữ liệu, vì vậy quý anh/chị vui lòng **đọc kỹ và điền đầy đủ** để không bỏ lỡ nhé.

Xin chân thành cảm ơn quý anh/chị đã dành thời gian thực hiện khảo sát này!

PHẦN 1		
STT	MÃ HÓA	CÂU HỎI
1	GT	Giới tính ☐ Nam ☐ Nữ
2	DT DT1 DT2 DT3 DT4 DT5	Độ tuổi ☐ Dưới 18 tuổi ☐ Từ 18 đến 27 tuổi ☐ Từ 28 đến 37 tuổi ☐ Từ 38 đến 47 tuổi ☐ Trên 47 tuổi
3	HV HV1 HV2 HV3	Trình độ học vấn ☐ Trung học phổ thông ☐ Đại học/ Cao đẳng ☐ Sau đại học
4	TN TN1	Thu nhập hiện tại (Bao gồm cả trợ cấp từ gia đình, xã hội) ☐ Dưới 5 triệu đồng/tháng

	TN2	O Từ 5 đến dưới 10 triệu đồng/tháng
	TN3	O Từ 10 đến dưới 15 triệu đồng/tháng
	TN4	O Trên 15 triệu đồng/tháng
5	NO	Hãy cho biết nơi anh/chị đang sinh sống/học tập/làm việc?
	NO1	O TP. Hồ Chí Minh (Chuyển tới phần tiếp theo)
	NO2	O Khác (Chuyển tới Phần 5: Lời cảm ơn và quà tặng)
PHẦN 2		
6	SD	Anh/chị đã từng mua hoặc sử dụng sản phẩm thời trang theo phong cách tối giản (ưu tiên thiết kế đơn giản, bền vững) chưa?
	SD1	O Đã từng (Chuyển tới phần tiếp theo)
	SD2	O Chưa từng (Chuyển tới Phần 5: Lời cảm ơn và quà tặng)
PHẦN 3: CÂU HỎI CHÍNH		
Bạn hãy cho biết mức độ đồng ý của mình đối với các nhận định sau đây về lối sống tối giản và thời trang bền vững bằng cách lựa chọn một trong năm mức độ từ 1 đến 5 nhé! (1): Hoàn toàn không đồng ý (2): Không đồng ý (3): Trung lập (4): Đồng ý (5): Hoàn toàn đồng ý		

STT	MÃ HÓA	CÂU HỎI	1	2	3	4	5
TÍNH THẨM MỸ GIẢN DỊ - SIMPLE AESTHETIC - SA							
1	SA1	Tôi ưa chuộng các thiết kế đơn giản, tinh tế theo phong cách tối giản.					
2	SA2	Tôi tin rằng việc lựa chọn thời trang tối giản giúp giảm lãng phí tài nguyên trong ngành may mặc.					
3	SA3	Tôi mua ít trang phục hơn, nhưng chú trọng vào chất lượng và vẻ đẹp bền vững với thời gian.					
4	SA4	Tôi tin rằng theo đuổi thời trang tối giản là một cách thiết thực để ủng hộ sự bền vững.					
GREENWASHING PERCEPTION - GW							
5	GW1	Tôi nhận thấy nhiều sản phẩm thời trang sử dụng từ ngữ gây hiểu lầm về mức độ thân thiện với môi trường.					
6	GW2	Tôi cảm thấy hình ảnh quảng cáo (ví dụ: hình thiên nhiên,					

		cây cỏ) thường được các hãng thời trang lạm dụng để tạo cảm giác "xanh" cho sản phẩm.					
7	GW3	Tôi cảm thấy các tuyên bố "bền vững" của nhiều thương hiệu thời trang thường rất mơ hồ và thiếu bằng chứng cụ thể					
8	GW4	Tôi cho rằng các thương hiệu thời trang thường phóng đại lợi ích môi trường thực sự mà sản phẩm mang lại.					
9	GW5	Tôi cho rằng các nhãn hàng thời trang thường che giấu thông tin quan trọng để sản phẩm có vẻ "xanh" hơn thực tế.					
NHẬN THỨC VỀ NHÃN MÁC BỀN VỮNG - SUSTAINABLE LABEL AWARENESS - LA							
10	LA1	Tôi cho rằng mình hiểu đúng ý nghĩa của nhãn mác "bền vững" trên quần áo.					
11	LA2	Tôi nhận biết được nhãn mác dành cho quần áo làm từ vật liệu tái chế.					

12	LA3	Khi mua sắm, tôi thường chú ý thông tin trên nhãn mác quần áo.					
14		Nếu bạn vẫn đang thực hiện khảo sát, hãy chọn số 4.					
MÔI QUAN TÂM ĐẾN MÔI TRƯỜNG - ENVIRONMENTAL CONCERN - EC							
13	EC1	Tôi quan tâm tới các vấn đề liên quan đến môi trường.					
14	EC2	Tôi sẵn lòng thay đổi thói quen tiêu dùng của mình để góp phần bảo vệ môi trường.					
15	EC3	Bảo vệ môi trường tự nhiên giúp nâng cao chất lượng cuộc sống của tôi.					
NHẬN THỨC VỀ GIÁ - PRICE PERCEPTION - PP							
16	PP1	Tôi tin rằng sử dụng sản phẩm thời trang bền vững là một lựa chọn kinh tế về lâu dài.					
17	PP2	Tôi thấy rằng sản phẩm thời trang bền vững có mức giá hợp lý.					
18	PP3	Tôi cho rằng sản phẩm thời					

		trang bền vững mang lại giá trị xứng đáng với số tiền bỏ ra.					
19	PP4	Tôi nghĩ rằng giá của thời trang bền vững phù hợp với chất lượng sản phẩm.					
CHỦ NGHĨA TỐI GIẢN - MINIMALISM - MN							
20	MN1	Tôi cố gắng sống giản dị và tránh mua những thứ không cần thiết.					
21	MN2	Khi mua sắm, tôi cân nhắc cẩn thận xem món đồ đó có cần thiết với mình hay không.					
22	MN3	Ngay cả khi có tiền, tôi cũng không mua sắm theo cảm hứng nhất thời.					
23	MN4	Tôi cố gắng sử dụng hết mọi món đồ mà mình sở hữu.					
Ý ĐỊNH TIÊU DÙNG THỜI TRANG BỀN VỮNG - SUSTAINABLE FASHION CONSUMPTION INTENTION - FI							
24	FI1	Tôi sẽ chia sẻ những điều tích cực về việc mua sắm thời trang bền vững với người khác.					

25	FI2	Tôi sẵn lòng mua các sản phẩm thời trang bền vững.					
26	FI3	Tôi sẽ giới thiệu các sản phẩm thời trang bền vững cho bạn bè của mình.					
27	FI4	Tôi sẽ mua sản phẩm thời trang bền vững cho bạn bè hoặc gia đình					
28	FI5	Tôi sẵn sàng phản bác những lời chỉ trích về thời trang bền vững.					
PHẦN 5: LỜI CẢM ƠN VÀ QUÀ TẶNG Một lần nữa, nhóm chúng em xin cảm ơn quý anh/chị đã dành thời gian thực hiện khảo sát, sự hỗ trợ của anh chị đã góp phần làm nên sự thành công của dự án.							

Source: Authors' own work

APPENDIX 2: Research on calculation and construction of measuring scale

Original scale	English Correction	Vietnamese Correction
1. Simple Aesthetics (Jain, V. K., Joy, V., & Sharma, P.,2024)		

TM1:I prefer minimalist aesthetics.	I prefer simple, elegant designs in a minimalist style.	Tôi ưa chuộng các thiết kế đơn giản, tinh tế theo phong cách tối giản.
TM2: It promotes simplicity in design and helps in optimization of resources.	I believe that choosing minimalist fashion helps reduce waste in the industry that can be assumed.	Tôi tin rằng việc lựa chọn thời trang tối giản giúp giảm lãng phí tài nguyên trong ngành may mặc.
TM3: I consume less and aesthetically beautiful resources.	I buy fewer clothes, but pay attention to the quality and beauty that lasts over time.	Tôi mua ít trang phục hơn, nhưng chú trọng vào chất lượng và vẻ đẹp bền vững với thời gian.
TM4: It supports minimalism by saving resources.	I believe that pursuing minimalist fashion is a practical way to support sustainability.	Tôi tin rằng theo đuổi thời trang tối giản là một cách thiết thực để ủng hộ sự bền vững.
0. Greenwashing Perception (Zhang et al.,2018)		

GW1: The products mislead with words regarding their environmental features.	I have noticed that many fashion products use misleading language about how environmentally friendly they are.	Tôi nhận thấy nhiều sản phẩm thời trang sử dụng từ ngữ gây hiểu lầm về mức độ thân thiện với môi trường.
GW2: The products mislead with visuals or graphics regarding their environmental features.	.I feel that promotional images (e.g., images of nature, plants) are often used by fashion brands to make their products appear “green”.	Tôi cảm thấy hình ảnh quảng cáo (ví dụ: hình thiên nhiên, cây cỏ) thường được các hãng thời trang lạm dụng để tạo cảm giác "xanh" cho sản phẩm.
GW3: The products are associated with green claims that are vague or seemingly unprovable.	I feel that many fashion brands’ “sustainability” claims are often vague and lack concrete evidence	Tôi cảm thấy các tuyên bố "bền vững" của nhiều thương hiệu thời trang thường rất mơ hồ và thiếu bằng chứng cụ thể
GW4: The products overstate or exaggerate what their green functionality actually is.	I believe that fashion brands often exaggerate the true environmental benefits of their products.	Tôi cho rằng các thương hiệu thời trang thường phóng đại lợi ích môi trường thực sự mà sản phẩm mang lại.

GW5: The products leave out or mask important information, making the green claims sound better than they are.	I believe that fashion brands often hide important information to make their products appear “greener” than they really are.	Tôi cho rằng các nhãn hàng thời trang thường che giấu thông tin quan trọng để sản phẩm có vẻ "xanh" hơn thực tế.
0. Sustainable Label Awareness (Yadav, S. S., & Kar, S. K.,2025)		
NM1: I know the meaning of the term Sustainable Labelled clothes.	I think I understand what the "sustainable" label on clothing means.	Tôi cho rằng mình hiểu đúng ý nghĩa của nhãn mác "bền vững" trên quần áo.
NM2: I am aware about recycled clothes labels.	I recognize labels for clothing made from recycled materials.	Tôi nhận biết được nhãn mác dành cho quần áo làm từ vật liệu tái chế.
NM3: I usually pay attention to information about labels on clothes.	When I shop, I pay attention to the information on clothing labels.	Khi mua sắm, tôi thường chú ý thông tin trên nhãn mác quần áo.
0. Environmental Concern (D’Souza et al., 2015)		

MT1: I am very concerned about the environment.	I care about environmental issues.	Tôi quan tâm tới các vấn đề liên quan đến môi trường.
MT2: I would be willing to reduce or change my consumption to help protect the environment	I am willing to change my consumption habits to help protect the environment	Tôi sẵn lòng thay đổi thói quen tiêu dùng của mình để góp phần bảo vệ môi trường
MT3: Protecting the natural environment increases my quality of life	Protecting the natural environment improves my quality of life.	Bảo vệ môi trường tự nhiên giúp nâng cao chất lượng cuộc sống của tôi.
0. Price Perception (Walsch et al.,2014)		
GI1: Sustainable fashion products would be economical	I believe that using sustainable fashion products is an economical choice in the long run.	Tôi tin rằng sử dụng sản phẩm thời trang bền vững là một lựa chọn kinh tế về lâu dài.
GI2: Sustainable fashion products are reasonably priced	I find that sustainable fashion products are reasonably priced.	Tôi thấy rằng sản phẩm thời trang bền vững có mức giá hợp lý.

GI3: Sustainable fashion products offer value for money	I think that sustainable fashion products provide good value for money.	Tôi cho rằng sản phẩm thời trang bền vững mang lại giá trị xứng đáng với số tiền bỏ ra.
GI4: Sustainable fashion products are good for the price.	I think that the price of sustainable fashion products is consistent with the quality of the products.	Tôi nghĩ rằng giá của thời trang bền vững phù hợp với chất lượng sản phẩm.
0. Minimalism (Iwata,2006)		
TG1: I try to live modestly and avoid buying superfluous goods	I try to live modestly and avoid buying unnecessary goods	Tôi cố gắng sống khiêm tốn và tránh mua những hàng hóa không cần thiết
TG2: When I go shopping, I carefully consider whether an item is vital to me.	When shopping, I carefully consider whether the item is necessary for me or not.	Khi mua sắm, tôi cân nhắc cẩn thận xem món đồ đó có cần thiết với mình hay không.

TG3: Even if I have money, it is not my policy to purchase anything on the spur of the moment.	Even when I have money, I do not buy on impulse.	Ngay cả khi có tiền, tôi cũng không mua sắm theo cảm hứng nhất thời.
TG4: I strive to keep the stuff I purchase for as long as possible.	I try to use up everything I own.	Tôi cố gắng sử dụng hết mọi món đồ mà mình sở hữu.
0. Sustainable Fashion Consumption Intention (Lee et al. (2023), Cho et al.,2024)		
I will talk positively about buying sustainable fashion	I will share positive things about buying sustainable fashion with others.	Tôi sẽ chia sẻ những điều tích cực về việc mua sắm thời trang bền vững với người khác.
I am willing to buy sustainable fashion	I am willing to buy sustainable fashion products.	Tôi sẵn lòng mua các sản phẩm thời trang bền vững.
I will recommend sustainable fashion products to my friends	I will recommend sustainable fashion products to my friends.	Tôi sẽ giới thiệu các sản phẩm thời trang bền vững cho bạn bè của mình.

I will buy sustainable fashion for my friends or family	I will buy sustainable fashion products for friends or family	Tôi sẽ mua sản phẩm thời trang bền vững cho bạn bè hoặc gia đình
I am willing to contradict the criticism of sustainable fashion	I am willing to refute criticisms of sustainable fashion.	Tôi sẵn sàng phản bác những lời chỉ trích về thời trang bền vững.

APPENDIX 3: SMARTPLS 4.0 OUTPUT

Characteristic	Category	Frequency	Percentage
Gender	Male	143	40,4%
	Female	211	59,6%
Age	Under 18 years old	13	3,7%
	From 18 to 27 years old	187	52,8%
	From 28 to 37 years old	79	22,3%
	From 38 to 47 years old	46	13,0%
	Over 47 years old	29	8,2%
Education Level	High School	25	7,1%

	University/College	257	72,6%
	Postgraduate	72	20,3%
Income	Less than 5 million VND/month	29	8,2%
	From 5 to less than 10 million VND/month	112	31,6%
	From 10 to less than 15 million VND/month	109	30,8%
	Over 15 million VND/month	104	29,4%

Results of Cronbach's Alpha, Composite Reliability, Outer Loadings, and Average Variance Extracted (AVE)

Scale		Cronbach's alpha	Composite Reliability (rho_A)	Composite Reliability (CR)	Outer Loading	Average Variance Extracted (AVE)
PP		0.734	0.734	0.832		0.554
	[PP1]				0.713	
	[PP2]				0.703	
	[PP3]				0.788	

	[PP4]				0.770	
GW		0.745	0.755	0.838		0.565
	[GW1]				0.718	
	[GW2]				0.745	
	[GW3]				0.696	
	[GW4]				0.732	
	[GW5]				0.703	
EC		0.565	0.565	0.565		0.665
	[EC1]				0.775	
	[EC2]				0.812	
	[EC3]				0.857	
LA		0.800	0.808	0.882		0.714
	[LA1]				0.849	
	[LA2]				0.870	
	[LA3]				0.814	
FI		0.790	0.791	0.864		0.613

	[FI1]				0.774	
	[FI2]				0.767	
	[FI3]				0.750	
	[FI4]				0.767	
	[FI5]				0.607	
MN		0.701	0.703	0.833		0.625
	[MN1]				0.699	
	[MN2]				0.745	
	[MN3]				0.791	
	[MN4]				0.745	
SA		0.793	0.802	0.865		0.615
	[SA1]				0.763	
	[SA2]				0.762	
	[SA3]				0.829	
	[SA4]				0.786	

Heterotrait-Monotrait Ratio (HTMT) of the Scales

	PP	GW	EC	LA	FI	MN	SA
PP							
GW	0.208						
EC	0.280	0.545					
LA	0.393	0.573	0.539				
FI	0.595	0.163	0.277	0.394			
MN	0.295	0.408	0.368	0.411	0.396		
SA	0.239	0.523	0.833	0.661	0.142	0.493	

Multicollinearity Statistics: Variance Inflation Factor (VIF) Results

	PP	GW	EC	LA	FI	MN	SA
PP					1.082	1.114	
GW						1.372	
EC					1.112	1.805	
LA						1.618	
FI							
MN					1.112		
SA						1.980	

R² Test Results

	R-square	R-square adjusted
FI	0.261	0.255
MN	0.190	0.178

Effect Size (f²) Results

	PP	GW	EC	LA	FI	MN	SA
PP					0.205	0.019	
GW						0.020	
EC					0.007	0.000	
LA						0.004	
FI							
MN					0.044		
SA						0.043	

Results of hypothesis testing in the model

	Original sample (O)	Sample mean (M)	Standard Deviation (STDEV)	T statistics (O/STDEV)	P-value
SA → MN	0.263	0.262	0.090	2.917	0.004
GW → MN	0.148	0.154	0.072	2.071	0.038

LA → MN	0.072	0.069	0.073	0.986	0.324
EC → MN	-0.016	-0.009	0.077	0.206	0.836
PP → MN	0.130	0.132	0.062	2.099	0.036
EC → FI	0.077	0.077	0.054	1.422	0.155
PP → FI	0.404	0.406	0.055	7.362	0.000
MN → FI	0.191	0.187	0.067	2.840	0.005

Consolidated table of hypothesis testing results

	Results	
	Sig	Conclude
H1: Simple aesthetics has a positive influence on minimalism.	0.004	Supported
H2: Greenwashing perception has a positive influence on the tendency to pursue minimalism.	0.038	Supported
H3: Sustainable label awareness has a positive influence on minimalism.	0.324	Rejected
H4: Environmental concern has a positive impact on minimalism.	0.836	Rejected

H5: Price perception has a positive influence on minimalism.	0.036	Supported
H6: Environmental concern has a positive impact on consumers' sustainable fashion consumption intention.	0.155	Rejected
H7: Price perception has a positive influence on sustainable fashion consumption intention.	0.000	Supported
H8: Minimalism has a positive impact on consumers' sustainable fashion consumption intention.	0.005	Supported

Mediation Analysis

	Original sample (O)	P-value	Result
EC → MN → FI	-0.003	0.842	Rejected
LA → MN → FI	0.014	0.411	Rejected
SA → MN → FI	0.050	0.008	Supported
PP → MN → FI	0.025	0.121	Rejected
GW → MN → FI	0.028	0.073	Rejected